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Modular utility system

Abstract

A kit of portable modular components for use in demountably configuring a variety of structural assemblies. The kit comprises three types of elongate structural support components wherein the first type has a pair of opposed male ends, the second type has a male end and an opposed female end, and the third type has a pair of opposed female ends, wherein the male ends are configured for demountable engagement with the female ends. Each of the male ends comprises a cylindrical body with at least one linear set of two spaced-apart prongs around the circumferential surface of the cylindrical body. Each of the female ends has a cylindrical receptacle with one or more linear channels for receiving therein the cylindrical body and the at least one linear set of prongs. The female ends are provided with locking assemblies for releasable engagement the male ends.

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Background/Summary

CROSS REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This non-provisional application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 16/138,422 filed on Sep. 21, 2018, which claims priority to International Application PCT/CA2017/050376 filed Mar. 24, 2017 which claims the benefit of and priority to U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 62/312,617 filed Mar. 24, 2016, which is incorporated herein by reference in its entirety.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) The present disclosure relates to the field of utility equipment and, in particular, to modular components for demountable engagement into various configurations of assemblies for use in engagement and/or support and/or operation and/or conveyance of equipment for multiple utility purposes.

BACKGROUND

(2) Utility equipment of various forms is essential to every industry and can range vastly in both size and complexity in order to meet the particular needs of a selected industry. Irrespective of the industry, most utility equipment is designed to have a single function. Consequently, a variety of utility equipment is required to meet the various needs of a selected industry.

(3) The filmmaking industry is one example of such an industry requiring various specialized utility equipment. Cinematic techniques in filmmaking, videography, and photography have increased in both scale and complexity. Such cinematic techniques depend on a wide range of utility equipment, in particular camera support equipment, that provide filmmakers with the technical means to create the camera shots needed for a scene or a cinematographic effect. Additionally, the necessary portability of film set equipment and properties of many kinds requires a large variety of carts, wheelbarrows, stands and the like to execute efficient movement around a working location.

(4) Various types of camera and motion support equipment are available and are widely used by filmmakers and photographers. Some commonly used equipment include, for example, jibs or

cranes to provide the ability to add vertical and sideways movement to a shot, and with the ability to achieve a high angle shot, depending on the size of the jib. Various types of dollies similarly range in size from the very large to compact systems to provide smooth rolling camera movement thereby enabling the addition of horizontal motion to a shot. Handheld and body-supported stabilizers and gimbals allow a smooth shot to be taken while the operator is walking, while maintaining the ability to control the pan and tilt movements of the camera. Sliders, for another example, are essentially a condensed, mountable version of a dolly on a supported track and provide smooth movement along a straight path.

(5) Each type of camera support equipment is designed to allow certain camera angles or dynamic motion. In this way, each type of camera support equipment is designed to provide a particular function to achieve a particular type of shot, with consideration of the challenges presented by a particular filming location. The functionality and usability of each type of camera support equipment is therefore limited and often results in the need to employ multiple types of camera support equipment for a given project. The limited versatility of camera support equipment has meant that each type is typically used individually or can sometimes be used in various combinations in order to provide filmmakers with some options for achieving a scene or effect. These options, however, are difficult to orchestrate, often due to the limitations of the location and the typically large and bulky size of the equipment and the cumbersome nature of transporting and setting up of the equipment, requiring time, money, and effort.

(6) Although current systems attempt to address challenges in portability and set-up/break-down of camera support equipment, there continues to be a need for systems that are easy to transport and to assemble, and further offer versatility and multi-functionality for supporting creative camera angles and motion without necessarily requiring a multitude of types of support equipment.

(7) The limitations found with camera support equipment are common with utility equipment in other industries such as construction, staging and others.

SUMMARY

(8) The present disclosure generally relates to modular utility system assemblies for engaging, supporting, manipulation of and operation of tools, equipment, instruments and other types of loads. More specifically, this disclosure pertains to sturdy and durable utility system assemblies for temporary use on a work site or location wherein the assemblies can be configured and quickly assembled by interconnecting and securely engaging a plurality of modular structural support components along with a selection modules designed for mounting, and optionally for operation, of tools or equipment or instruments, modules having rolling components such as wheels, castors and the like, end-capping modules, and other types of modules that may be useful in configuring such modular utility system assemblies. After the need for a modular utility system assembly has been satisfied and the assembly is no longer required on a work site or location, it can be quickly and easily dis-assembled into the individual modular elements that can be collected together for transport or storage.

(9) One embodiment of the present disclosure relates to three types of elongate structural support components wherein the first type has a pair of opposed male ends, the second type has a male end and an opposed female end, and the third type has a pair of opposed female ends, wherein the male ends are configured for demountable engagement with the female ends. Each of the male ends comprises a cylindrical body with one or more linear set(s) of two spaced-apart prongs on the circumferential surface of the cylindrical body. Each of the female ends has a cylindrical receptacle with one or more linear channels for receiving therein the cylindrical body and the at least one linear set of prongs. The female ends are provided with locking assemblies for releasable engagement of the male ends.

(10) According to one aspect, a cylindrical body of a male end may have two or more linear sets of two or more spaced-apart prongs wherein the linear sets are equidistantly spaced apart around the circumferential surface of the cylindrical body. According to another aspect, a cylindrical

receptacle of a female end may have two or more equidistantly spaced-apart linear channels to receive therein the cylindrical body having two or more linear sets of prongs.

(11) According to one aspect, the male ends of the first and/or second types of elongate structural support components may be rotatable within the female cylindrical receptacles of the second and/or third types of elongate structural support components. According to another aspect, the male ends of the first and/or second types of elongate structural support components may be fixed and securely engaged within the female cylindrical receptacles of the second and/or third types of elongate structural support components so that the male ends are not rotatable within the female receptacles.

(12) According to another embodiment of the present disclosure, one or more of the three types of elongate structural support components may have an elongate structural element interposed the two opposing ends of the elongate structural support components. According to one aspect, the elongate structural element may be tubular or rod-like. According to another aspect, the elongate structural element may have a circular cross-section or an elliptical cross-section or a square cross-section or a rectangular cross-section or a trapezoidal cross-section or a triangular cross-section or a hexagonal cross-section or an octagonal cross-section or a decagonal cross-section or an I-shaped cross-section.

(13) Another embodiment of the present disclosure relates to modules configured for demountable engagement of an imaging device and/or a sound recording device and/or a sound reproduction device and/or a lighting device and/or a light-directing device. Some modules may be provided with wheels or castors or rollers, and the like. Some modules may be provided with seats or caps or weight components. Some modules may be provided with hand grips or fixed foot pegs or adjustable foot pegs, end-caps, and the like. Some modules may have telescoping mechanisms whereby one of the ends may be controllably extended out of the modules and then controllably retracted into the modules. Some modules may comprise two mating components that can be used for clamping onto cylindrical components.

(14) Another embodiment of the present disclosure pertains to mounting blocks to which may be engaged one or more male ends configured as disclosed herein. According to some aspects, the mounting blocks may be elbow-shaped, cubes, triangles, pyramids, hexagonal, octagonal, and the like.

(15) Some embodiments of the present disclosure relate to kits containing pluralities of multiple modular components disclosed herein.

(16) Some embodiments of the present disclosure relate to modular elongate structural support components and to modules for demountable engagement of other elements thereto, that have been down-sized to make them suitable for handling and use by juveniles during play and learning activities.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

(1) These and other features of the disclosure will become more apparent in the following detailed description in which reference is made to the appended drawings, wherein:

(2) FIGS. 1A and 1B are perspective views of an example of a male/receptacle closed-tube rotator module with one male component extending longitudinally from the closed-tube end, wherein FIG. 1A is a perspective view with the male component extending forward with a tension-adjustment screw knob shown on the left, and FIG. 1B is a perspective view of the rear of the male/receptacle closed-tube rotator module with the tension-adjustment screw knob shown on the right;

(3) FIG. 2 is an exploded perspective view from the rear of the male/receptacle closed-tube rotator module shown in FIG. 1;

(4) FIG. 3A is a perspective view of an example of a 2-way closed-tube rotator hub assembly, while FIG. 3B illustrates the male/receptacle closed-tube rotator module from FIGS. 1 and 2 configured into a 6-way hub assembly with four male member side-mount assemblies demountably engaged with the side wall of the rotator closed-tube housing;

(5) FIG. 4A is a side view of an example of a double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module, and FIG. 4B is a cross-sectional end view thereof, showing an example of a retaining lock contained therein;

(6) FIGS. 5A and 5B are perspective views of the double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module shown in FIG. 4 configured into a 4-way hub assembly having two male member side-mount assemblies demountably engaged with the side walls of the extension-tube housing, wherein FIG. 5A is a whole view and FIG. 5B is a partially exploded view;

(7) FIGS. 6A and 6B are perspective views of closed-tube joiner hub assemblies.

(8) FIG. 6A shows a 3-way hub assembly having one joiner receptacle, a linearly aligned male component, and one male member side-mount assembly demountably engaged with the side wall of the joiner closed-tube housing. FIG. 6B shows a 5-way hub assembly having one receptacle, a linearly aligned male component, and three male member side-mount assemblies;

(9) FIG. 7 is an exploded perspective view of the 5-way hub assembly shown in FIG. 6B;

(10) FIGS. 8A and 8B illustrate an example of a male/receptacle side-opening joiner module having one side-opening receptacle and a linearly aligned male member extension-tube end assembly, wherein FIG. 8A is a whole perspective view and FIG. 8B is an exploded perspective view;

(11) FIGS. 9A and 9B illustrate an example of a double-male joiner module, wherein FIG. 9A is a whole perspective view and FIG. 9B is an exploded perspective view;

(12) FIGS. 10A and 10B illustrate an example of a double-male extension-tube joiner module having at each end a male member extension-tube end assembly, wherein FIG. 10A is a whole perspective view and FIG. 10B is an exploded perspective view;

(13) FIGS. 11A and 11B show the double-male extension-tube joiner module from FIG. 10 reconfigured into a 6-way hub assembly, wherein FIG. 11A is a whole perspective view and FIG. 11B is a partially exploded perspective view;

(14) FIGS. 12A and 12B illustrate an example of a double-male adapter joiner module, wherein FIG. 12A is a whole perspective view and FIG. 12B is an exploded perspective view;

(15) FIGS. 13A-13D illustrate examples of variants of side-mount bracket modules wherein FIG. 13A is an exploded perspective view of a 30° side-mount bracket module having a 30° angle male member mount bracket and an optional clamp bracket, FIG. 13B is an exploded perspective view of a multi-angle side-mount bracket module having two multi-angle male member mount brackets being demountably engaged with four bracket screws, FIG. 13C is a perspective view of an example of a 90° offset side-mount bracket module, and FIG. 13D is a perspective view of an example of a 45° offset side-mount bracket module;

(16) FIGS. 14A-14F illustrate examples of variants of male member mounting block modules wherein FIG. 14A shows a 90° elbow male member mounting block module, FIG. 14B shows a cube male member mounting block module, FIG. 14C shows a triangular male member mounting block module, FIG. 14D shows a pyramidal male member mounting block module, FIG. 14E shows a hexagonal male member mounting block module, and FIG. 14F shows an octagonal male member mounting block module;

(17) FIGS. 15A and 15B show an example of a 5° increment adjustable male member mount module wherein FIG. 15A is a whole perspective view of the module, and FIG. 15B is an exploded perspective view of the module;

(18) FIGS. 16A and 16B show an example of a baseplate module in an assembly having two mounting brackets and three male member plate assemblies wherein FIG. 16A is a whole perspective view of the module, and FIG. 16B is an exploded perspective view of the module;

(19) FIGS. 17A and 17B show another example of a baseplate assembly wherein FIG. 17A is a whole perspective view of the assembly, and FIG. 17B is an exploded perspective view of the assembly, configured with one of a first example of a double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module and two of a first example of male/receptacle extension-tube joiner modules;

(20) FIGS. 18A and 18B are perspective views of an example of a tray assembly, wherein FIG. 18A is a whole view, and FIG. 18B is a partial exploded view of the assembly, configured with four of a second example of double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules;

(21) FIGS. 19A and 19B are perspective views of an example of a desk assembly wherein FIG. 19A is a whole view, and FIG. 19B is a partial exploded view showing some details of the assembly, configured with two of a first example of double-receptacle side-opening joiner modules and four of a second example of double-receptacle side-opening joiner modules;

(22) FIGS. 20A-20D are perspective views of two examples of lighting mount modules wherein FIGS. 20A and 20B are a whole view and a partially exploded view, respectively, of a $\frac{5}{8}$ " spigot lighting mount module, and FIGS. 20C and 20D are a whole view and an exploded view, respectively, of a spigot-adaptor lighting mount module;

(23) FIG. 21A is a perspective view of an example of a rail-rolling module, and FIG. 21B is a perspective view of an example of a rail-surround rolling module;

(24) FIG. 22 is an exploded perspective view of the rail-rolling modules shown in FIG. 21;

(25) FIGS. 23A-23D are perspective views of two examples of wheel modules wherein FIGS. 23A and 23B are a whole view and a partially exploded view, respectfully, of a wheel module assembly having a standard wheel attached by an axle bolt to a wheel-axle/receptacle side-opening joiner module, while FIGS. 23C and 23D are a whole view and an exploded view, respectfully, of a caster wheel module assembly;

(26) FIGS. 24A and 24B are a whole perspective view and an exploded perspective view, respectively, of an example of a leveling foot module, while FIG. 24C is an exploded perspective view of an example of a foot plate module;

(27) FIGS. 25A and 25B, are a partially exploded perspective view and a whole perspective view, respectively, of an example of a pivotable support module demountably engaged with a pad component, while FIG. 25C is a whole view of the pivotable support module demountably engaged with an example of a suction-cup component;

(28) FIGS. 26A and 26B are perspective views of an example of a weight module assembly wherein FIG. 26A is a whole view and FIG. 26B is a partially exploded view of the assembly configured with one of a second double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module;

(29) FIGS. 27A-27C illustrate an example of a telescoping extension module wherein FIG. 27A is a whole perspective view, FIG. 27B is an exploded perspective view, and FIG. 27C is a cross-sectional view showing the threaded rod and retaining components contained therein;

(30) FIGS. 28A-28E illustrate an example of a grip end-cap module wherein FIG. 28A is a perspective view showing the outer sleeve of the module in a locked position, FIG. 28B is an exploded perspective view, FIG. 28C is an exploded perspective view showing the outer sleeve in the locked position, FIG. 28D is a top view showing the outer sleeve in an unlocked position, and FIG. 28E is a top view showing the outer sleeve in the locked position;

(31) FIGS. 29A and 29B are perspective views of an example of a shell end-cap module mounted onto one of a first male/receptacle extension-tube rotator module wherein FIG. 29A is a whole view and FIG. 29B is a partially exploded view;

(32) FIGS. 30A and 30B are a whole perspective view and an exploded perspective view, respectively of an example of a female dome pad end-cap module mounted onto the exemplary shell end-cap module shown in FIG. 29, while FIGS. 30C and 30D are a whole perspective view and an exploded perspective view of an example of a male dome pad end-cap module fitted with a male member flat-mount assembly;

(33) FIGS. 31A and 31B are a whole perspective view and an exploded perspective view of an

example of a seat module fitted with a male member plate assembly;

(34) FIGS. **32A** and **32B** are a whole perspective view and an exploded perspective view of an example of a bumper end-cap module;

(35) FIGS. **33A** and **33B** are a whole perspective view and an exploded perspective view of a soft end-cap component, FIG. **33C** is a perspective view of the soft end-cap component mounted into a closed-tube rotator hub assembly, FIG. **33D** is a perspective view of a hard end-cap component and FIG. **33E** is a perspective view of the hard end-cap component mounted into a closed-tube rotator hub assembly, and FIG. **33F** is an exploded perspective view of a flat end-cap component shown with an extension-tube housing;

(36) FIG. **34** is a perspective view of an example of a crab-steering dolly system assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(37) FIG. **35** is a perspective view of an example of a vertical rail-tracking dolly system assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(38) FIG. **36** is a perspective view of an example of a lateral mounted rail-tracking dolly system assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(39) FIG. **37** is a perspective view of an example of a rolling jib system assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(40) FIG. **38** is a perspective view of an example of a low-angle baseplate support system assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(41) FIG. **39** is a perspective view of an example of a lateral ground rail-tracking dolly system assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(42) FIG. **40** is a perspective view of an example of a double-baseplate A-frame dolly system assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(43) FIG. **41** is a perspective view of an example of a four-caster baseplate dolly system on casters, assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(44) FIG. **42** is a perspective view of an example of a hand-held camera stabilizer assembly assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(45) FIG. **43** is a perspective view of an example of a vertical rail-tracking stand assembly assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(46) FIG. **44** is a perspective view of an example of a lighting support rack system assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(47) FIG. **45** is a perspective view of an example of an A-frame spooling cart system assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(48) FIG. **46** is a perspective view of an example of a pull cart system assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein;

(49) FIG. **47** is a perspective view of an example of a utility cart system assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein; and

(50) FIG. **48** is a perspective view of an example of a modular workstation assembled with some of the modular components disclosed herein.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

Definitions

(51) Unless defined otherwise, all technical and scientific terms used herein have the same meaning as commonly understood by one of ordinary skill in the art to which this disclosure relates.

(52) As used herein, the term “about” refers to an approximately $\pm 10\%$ variation from a given value. It is to be understood that such a variation is always included in any given value provided herein, whether or not it is specifically referred to.

(53) As used herein, the term “perspective view” refers to a three-dimensional view of a component or a module or an assembly disclosed herein that portrays height, width, and depth of the component or module or assembly for a more realistic image and representation.

(54) As used herein, the term “top view” refers to an illustration of a component or a module or an

assembly that looks directly down on the top surface of the component or module or assembly.

(55) As used herein, the term “back view” refers to an illustration of a component or a module or an assembly that looks horizontally and directly at the rear of the component or module or assembly.

(56) As used herein, the term “front view” refers to an illustration of a component or a module or an assembly that looks horizontally and directly at the front of the component or module or assembly.

(57) As used herein, the term “side view” refers to an illustration of a component or a module or an assembly that looks horizontally and directly at a side of the component or module or assembly.

(58) As used herein, the term “bottom view” refers to an illustration of a component or a module or an assembly that looks directly up on the bottom surface of the component or module or assembly.

(59) As used herein, the terms “rotator module” or “rotator assembly” mean a component or assembly that is configured for demountable engagement with another module or assembly with a controlled rotational functionality whereby a structurally secure and stable connection is provided between the two modules or assemblies. A rotator module may comprise: (i) one rotator receptacle and an opposed male end; (ii) two opposed rotator receptacles; or (iii) one rotator receptacle and an opposed joiner receptacle, separated by a cylindrical tube or rod, or a square tube or rod, or a rectangular tube or rod, or a trapezoidal tube or rod, or a triangular tube or rod, or a hexagonal tube or rod, or an octagonal tube or rod, or a decagonal tube or rod, or an I-shaped tube or rod wherein the tube or rod may be of varying lengths to provide varying lengths of extension between the receptacles, or between the receptacles and male ends. Certain rotator modules defined as “hub module” or “hub assembly”, may be configured to provide pivotable and lockable angular interconnection points for a plurality of modules within an assembly system.

(60) As used herein, the terms “joiner module” or “joiner assembly” mean a component that is configured to provide a demountable structural connection and extension between selected modules. A joiner module may comprise: (i) one joiner receptacle and an opposed male end; (ii) two opposed joiner receptacles; or (iii) two male ends, which are separated by a cylindrical tube or rod, or a square tube or rod, or a rectangular tube or rod, or a trapezoidal tube or rod, or a triangular tube or rod, or a hexagonal tube or rod, or an octagonal tube or rod, or a decagonal tube or rod, or an I-shaped tube or rod wherein the tube or rod may be of varying lengths to provide varying lengths of extension between the joiner receptacles, or between the joiner receptacles and male ends, or between the male ends. Certain joiner modules defined as “hub module” or “hub assembly” may be configured to provide pivotable and lockable angular interconnection points for a plurality of modules within an assembly system.

(61) As used herein, the terms “hub module” or “hub assembly” mean a component or assembly that is configured to provide a structural angular interconnection point between selected modules. A hub module or assembly may comprise multiple male members and/or receptacles in various numbers and orientations to provide a variety of structural configuration options. Hub modules and hub assemblies may be defined, according to some embodiments, to be of a group of modular components wherein each module or assembly is configured for a different structural requirement having a different number and orientations of male members and/or receptacles. According to some embodiments, hub modules and hub assemblies may be defined as a modular configuration comprising a demountable assembly of one or more male members with other modules such as, for example, a joiner module or a rotator module, to thereby provide a particular function to the hub modules or hub assemblies and whereby direct structural demountable connections can be made by the added male members.

(62) As used herein, the term “male member mount modules” means a category of modules, which include male member side-mount bracket modules and male member mounting block modules, having a demountable engagement mechanism for fixed or pivotable incorporation into an assembly, allowing for special-function hub assemblies.

(63) As used herein, the terms “tool support module” and “load support module” mean a category

of modules having a demountable engagement mechanism for fixed or pivotable incorporation into an assembly wherein the tool support module or load support module directly interface with a selected tool or load. A tool support assembly and load support assembly may be configured by a user for pivotable or fixed attachment of a selected tool or load to the assembly.

(64) As used herein, the terms “baseplate module” and “baseplate assembly” mean a module or assembly configured for stable and secure demountable engagement with a camera, a microphone, or other tool or supported load.

(65) As used herein, the terms “tray module” or “tray assembly” refer to a component that is configured to provide a pivotable or fixed box-support function or tray-support function for transporting equipment, properties, materials, supplies, and the like around a worksite or other location. Alternatively, a tray module or tray assembly may be used as a shelving system, or a table, or a staging platform.

(66) As used herein, the terms “table module” or “table assembly” or “desk module” or “desk assembly” or “shelf module” or “shelf assembly” refer to a component or modular assembly that provides a table or workstation or shelving configuration, or alternatively may be used as a staging platform.

(67) As used herein, the term “lighting mount module” refers to a component or modular assembly that may be incorporated into an assembly to provide a lighting mount spigot or other attachment means for demountable engagement with standard lighting equipment or other similar loads.

(68) As used herein, the term “base modules” means a category of modules having a demountable engagement mechanism for fixed or pivotable attachment into an assembly to provide roller modules, or wheel modules, or counterbalance/base weight modules, or foot modules, or extendable support modules for an assembly.

(69) As used herein, the terms “rail-rolling module” means a modular assembly configured with two pairs of inline wheel assemblies to provide a rolling or sliding function on a rail track assembly.

(70) As used herein, the terms “rail-surround rolling module” means a modular assembly configured with two opposed sets of two pairs of inline wheel assemblies configured to provide a rolling or sliding function on a rail track assembly.

(71) As used herein, the term “rail track assembly” refers to a modular assembly configured to receive and support thereon a rail-rolling module or alternatively, a rail-surround rolling module to provide a desired pathway for transport therealong of a support assembly. Rail track assemblies may be straight or curved, and may optionally have flexible lengths to enable assembly of desired curves and curvilinear configurations.

(72) As used herein, the term “wheel module” means a modular assembly having a fixed or alternatively a pivotable wheel, for demountable engagement into a support assembly to provide the support assembly with a rolling functionality. The wheels may be pneumatic, solid rubber, plastic, or foam.

(73) As used herein, the terms “weight module” and “weight assembly” refer to a component or modular assembly that provides an operational counterweight, base weight, or weighted foot module functionality within a support assembly. Weight modules and weight assemblies can be configured in a variety of sizes, weights, and modules to provide a diverse range of support options.

(74) As used herein, the term “telescoping extension module” means a component providing a two-way structural extension having a length-adjustment mechanism to enable extension and retraction of the linear length of the module.

(75) As used herein, the term “leveling foot module” means a component for assemblies requiring a foot component with a height-adjustment mechanism to facilitate configurations of assemblies to be positioned on uneven surfaces or terrain.

(76) As used herein, the term “end-cap modules” means a category of modules having a

demountable engagement mechanism to provide a terminus and a grip function or a handle function or a foot function or a pad function or a bumper function or a cap function, that may be incorporated into a structural support assembly.

(77) As used herein, the term “seat module” means a modular assembly with a seat component for incorporation into a structural support assembly where there is a requirement for an onboard operator such as in a ride-along dolly assembly, or alternatively, as a component of a stool, bench, or workstation assembly.

(78) As used herein, the term “unit scale” refers to the scalable units of measure within which the relative proportions of the configurable modular components of a system may be universally constructed to allow cross-compatibility of the modules, and in any stated values used to inform cross-compatibility and not to be intended to limit the sizes or relative proportions of a system of the present disclosure. The units of measure may be in system format units-of-scale, metric format, or imperial format.

(79) As used herein, the term “system format” means shared-design characteristics of scale and demountable engagement features of a group of modules disclosed herein, wherein each of the modules comprises similar or compatible mechanisms to facilitate demountable engagement with each of the other modules, and which may optionally share a system-wide unit scale.

(80) The modular utility and support assemblies disclosed herein comprise a plurality of modules that may be demountably engaged into a wide assortment of combinations to thereby form assemblies that can be used in various stationary and mobile load-bearing equipment and materials support capacities. The modularity of the systems allows them to be disassembled into individual modular assemblies and/or components to facilitate ease of transport and storage. As well, the modularity of the systems disclosed herein enables multi-functionality in that the individual modules can be easily configured into one type of assembly, and then quickly and easily broken down for transport and/or storage, and then demountably engaged into new configurations of different types of assemblies with different types of functionalities.

(81) The modular components disclosed herein generally comprise a demountable engagement mechanism that enable the modules to be quickly, easily, stably, and securely interconnected and locked into place. In this way, modules can be quickly and securely interconnected into a wide variety of useful utility assemblies for demountably engaging, supporting, and manipulating various types of tools, equipment, instruments, and the like. Alternatively, modules can be quickly and securely interconnected into a wide variety of useful utility assemblies for containing and transporting loads about a site, for example a work site or recreational site, and once a utility assembly has been completed on a site, it can then be quickly and easily dismantled by disengagement and disassembly of the individual modules for removal and transport to a storage facility or alternatively, to another site for use to configure other types of utility assemblies.

(82) There is no limit on the types of utility systems that can be configured and assembled by demountable engagement of the modular components disclosed herein. Most utility assembly configurations will generally comprise a plurality of rotator modules, a plurality of joiner modules, a plurality of hub modules and/or hub assemblies, a plurality of male member mount modules, a plurality of tool/load support modules, a plurality of base modules, and a plurality of end-cap modules wherein the plurality of modules interconnect together in varying arrangements to form various utility or support systems.

(83) One embodiment of the present disclosure relates to three types of portable modular components that can be used for demountable engagement with each other to configure a wide variety of structural assemblies. The first type of portable modular components comprises an elongate structural support component having a pair of opposed male ends. The second type of portable modular components comprises an elongate structural support component having a pair of opposed ends wherein a first end is a male end and a second end is a female end. The third type of portable modular components comprises an elongate structural support component having a pair of

opposed female ends. The male ends of the first and second types of portable modular components are configured for demountable engagement with the female ends of the second and third types of portable modular components.

(84) According to another embodiment of the present disclosure, the first type of elongate structural support component and/or the second type of elongate structural support component and/or the third type of elongate structural support component may have an elongate structural element interposed the pair of opposed ends. According to one aspect, the elongate structural element may be a tube. According to another aspect, the elongate structural element may be a rod.

(85) According to one aspect, each of the male ends may comprise a cylindrical body with at least one linear set of prongs, or more than one set spaced apart, on the circumferential surface of the cylindrical body wherein each set of prongs has two or more spaced-apart prongs. According to some aspects, some of the male ends may have two linear sets of prongs spaced apart around the circumference of the cylindrical body, or alternatively, between three and twelve sets of prongs spaced apart around the circumference of the cylindrical body. According to some aspects, each set of prongs may have between one and eight spaced-apart prongs. According to some aspects, some of the male ends may have no prongs.

(86) According to another aspect, each of the female ends may have a cylindrical receptacle for receiving therein a male cylindrical body disclosed herein. The female receptacle may have at least one linear channel for slidably receiving therein the prongs of the male ends. According to some aspects, some of the female ends may have receptacles with two linear channels spaced apart around the circumference of the receptacle for receiving therein a male cylindrical body having two linear sets of prongs spaced apart around the circumference of the cylindrical body. Alternatively, some of the female ends may have receptacles with between three and twelve spaced-apart linear channels for slidably receiving therein a male cylindrical body having between three and twelve linear sets of prongs spaced apart around the circumference of the cylindrical body. According to another aspect, each linear channel in the receptacle(s) of the female ends of the second type or third type of elongate structural support components or elements may have one or more side channels extending therefrom fully or partially around the cylindrical receptacle for rotational and demountable engagement with the spaced-apart prongs on a male cylindrical body. According to another aspect, a female end may have no linear channels where demountably engaging a male cylindrical body of a male end having no prongs. According to another aspect, some of the female ends may be provided with a locking assembly for releasable engagement therewith one of the male ends.

(87) According to another embodiment of the present disclosure, one or more male ends of the first type or second type of elongate structural support components or elements may be rotatable around a longitudinal axis of the second type or third type of elongate structural support components or elements.

(88) According to another embodiment of the present disclosure, one or more female ends of the second type or third type of elongate structural support components or elements may be rotatable around a longitudinal axis of the first type or second type of elongate structural support components or elements.

(89) According to another embodiment of the present disclosure, one or more of the first type of elongate structural support components or elements, and/or the second type of elongate structural support components or elements, and/or the third type of elongate structural support components or elements may have one male end extending radially outward therefrom, wherein the male end comprises a cylindrical body with at least one linear set of prongs, or more than one set spaced apart, on the circumferential surface of the cylindrical body, wherein the male end is configured for rotational and demountable engagement with a female end. According to one aspect, there may be two or more male ends extending radially outward, in the same plane or a different plane, from the first type of elongate structural support components or elements, and/or the second type of elongate

structural support components or elements, and/or the third type of elongate structural support components or elements, wherein each of said male ends comprises a cylindrical body with at least one linear set of prongs, or more than one set spaced apart, on the circumferential surface of the cylindrical body, wherein the male ends are configured for rotational and demountable engagement with female ends.

(90) Another embodiment of the present disclosure pertains to end-cap modules having a male end component for demountable engagement with a female end of the second type of elongate structural support components or elements, or of the third type of elongate structural support components or elements. Another embodiment of the present disclosure pertains to end-cap modules having a female end component for demountable engagement with a male end of the first type of elongate structural support components or elements, or of the second type of elongate structural support components or elements.

(91) The modularity of the components and assemblies disclosed herein enables and facilitates the customization of utility assemblies. According to some embodiments disclosed herein, there is provided a customizable kit comprising pluralities of various modular components that may be assembled into selected or certain types of desired utility assemblies and/or support assemblies. In this way, the modular components, assemblies, and systems of the present disclosure provide on-site versatility and ease-of-use. For the purposes of illustrating the versatility and ease-of-use and configuration of the present modules, the following non-limiting description will refer to examples of utility assemblies that are useful for demountable engagement with cameras, sound equipment, lighting equipment, props, and other types of equipment used in filmmaking, videography, and photography applications, as well as some general utility-cart applications, and as well as some general workstation applications.

(92) Some examples of embodiments of the modular components and modular assemblies of the present disclosure will be described in reference to FIGS. **1-33** to illustrate various types of demountably engageable modules that may be securely and stably interconnected and assembled into many different configurations for engaging, supporting, and conveying various types of utility equipment and/or tools and/or devices and/or components, and/or parts and/or materials and/or supplies within and around a film set or a production studio or a photography studio or a performance venue or a sporting venue, or other locations commonly used for filming movies, videos, television programs, sports, news, documentaries, music videos, time-lapse photography, and still photography. Those skilled in these arts will understand how to securely and stably demountably engage the modules and modular assemblies disclosed herein for assemblies that will be useful in other types of sites such as construction, landscaping, agricultural, industrial, healthcare, retail, warehouses and the like, or alternatively, for use in some household and recreational applications. The numbers and types of modules that may be incorporated into a particular assembly will vary depending on the intended end-use of the utility or support system. However, an assembled system will generally comprise: one or more of a group of rotator modules exemplified in FIGS. **1** to **5**; one or more of a group of joiner modules exemplified in FIGS. **6** to **12**; one or more of a group of male member mount modules exemplified in FIGS. **13** to **15**; one or more of a group of hub modules and hub assemblies exemplified in FIGS. **3**, **5** to **7**, **11**, and **13** to **15**; one or more of a group of tool/load support modules exemplified in FIGS. **16** to **20**; one or more of a group of base modules exemplified in FIGS. **21** to **27**, and one or more of a group of end-cap modules exemplified in FIGS. **28** to **33**.

(93) The modules can be used to assemble a variety of utility systems and support structures, for example, dollies, carts, tracks, stands, tables, workstations, seating, shelving, bed-frames, railings, staging, partitions, and the like. FIGS. **34-48** illustrate examples of various types of utility and support assemblies that can be configured by combinations of the modular components and modular assemblies disclosed herein.

(94) It should be noted that all the modules disclosed herein provide universal interconnectivity

into a variety of utility system assemblies to provide a wide range of functional capabilities, or alternatively, a specialized functionality. After the need for the assemblies is concluded, they are easily dismantled into the individual modular components for transport and/or storage. For example, baseplate modules and assemblies such as those exemplified in FIGS. **16** and **17** are useful for securing thereto a camera, microphone, or such equipment or tool. According to other embodiments, one or more tray modules and one or more table/desk modules (FIGS. **18** and **19**) can be configured for transporting equipment, materials, supplies, and the like around a location, and may be configured as a mobile or stationary workstation. One or more lighting mount modules (FIG. **20**) can be incorporated into a utility system assembly for demountable engagement thereto of lighting or sound or other similar equipment. According to other embodiments, wheel modules (FIG. **23**) can be configured to provide a rolling function to a system assembly, or foot modules (FIGS. **24** and **25**) may be included for stationary setups. According to other embodiments, a system assembly may comprise one or more rail-rolling modules (FIGS. **21** and **22**) upon which a system can travel on, or be passed through by, an extended length or series of rail track assemblies (FIGS. **34**, **35**, **36**, **39** and **43**). Additionally, weight modules (FIG. **26**) can be included in a system for structural counter-balancing and base stability options when required. Additionally, a system assembly may include one or more telescoping extension modules (FIG. **27**). One or more of a group of end-cap modules (FIGS. **28** to **33**), including handle, foot, pad, seat, bumper, and cap components and modules may also be provided within a system for functions of various end-use requirements.

(95) Demountable Engagement Mechanisms

(96) A key feature of the embodiments of the present disclosure pertains to mechanisms enabling and facilitating quick, stable and secure demountable engagement of one module with another module so that the modules are securely and stably locked together. Some of the modules disclosed herein have one end or both ends configured to provide a functional pivot point that allows rotational movement in 360° at the one end or both ends.

(97) FIGS. **1** to **33** depict a range of exemplary interconnecting modules which generally embody the structural components and framework of the exemplary utility systems and support structures disclosed herein. Each of these modules comprises all or part of a reversible joining mechanism, according to embodiments of the present disclosure, and are referred to for illustration purposes. It will be understood that all or part of the varying embodiments of the reversible joining mechanism can be made a component of any module to allow interconnection into a larger system according to embodiments described herein. A reversible joining mechanism may comprise a receptacle in one module, as illustrated in units **11**, **211**, **252**, configured to receive and engage, on another module, a male member having a male component **70**.

(98) The male component **70** generally comprises a cylindrical body having a first collar **87a** (i.e., the distal collar) with a chamfered leading edge **86** that functions as a retaining-lock chamfer, and a neck **88** separating the first collar **87a** from a second collar **87b** (i.e., the proximal collar). Four prongs **82** extend radially outward from each of the collars **87a**, **87b**. The prongs **82** are configured for sliding engagement, for example, with prong-retaining slots **223** provided therefor in a joiner receptacle **211** (FIG. **6**), or with prong-retaining slots **262** provided therefor in a side-opening joiner receptacle **252**, or with prong-retaining slots **630** provided therefor in a grip end-cap module **625** (FIG. **28**). Alternatively, prongs **82** may be unobstructed within a rotator receptacle **11** (FIGS. **1**, **3**, and **5**) to allow a full 360° rotation of a male component **70** within the receptacle **11**. A male component may have two to eight spaced apart collars with each collar having two to twelve spaced-apart prongs **82** extending outwardly therefrom for slidable engagement with a receptacle configured to receive and engage the male component.

(99) Some of the modules disclosed herein may have a receptacle **11** in a housing **15** provided with reversible joining mechanism that comprises a pivot lock **60** for releasable engagement with a male end of another module. According to an aspect, a module housing may have two or more spaced-

apart pivot locks **60** situated around the circumference of the module housing. As shown in FIG. 2, some modules may have a pivot lock **60** with a pivot-lock indexing peg **62** which reversibly locks its module against a second module whereby the indexing peg **62** extends into a pivot-lock sprocket **74, 112, 216, 272, 284, 362, 396, 423, 506** (FIGS. **1, 3, 6, 9, 10, 13, 15, 16, 20**, respectively). A pivot-lock sprocket may have around its outer edge, for example, sixteen slots that provide sixteen locking positions at 22.5° increments.

(100) Rotator Modules

(101) The exemplary rotator modules shown in FIGS. **1-5, 26**, and **29** comprise a reversible joining mechanism as disclosed herein, thereby allowing the modules to be reversibly interconnected with other modules of the system. The rotator modules are configured to provide a rotation functionality for various pivotable connection points between selected modules throughout an assembly.

According to some embodiments, a rotator module can provide a pan and/or tilt function for a tool support module or a load support module or tool support assembly or a load support assembly and device mounted thereon such as a camera or other load. Also, a rotator module can provide other functional pivot points within an assembly, for example, such as a wheel module's directional and/or drive rotation.

(102) According to some embodiments, a tool support assembly or a load support assembly may comprise one or more of a group of closed-tube rotator modules having different lengths, which may be sized in reference to a system format-wide unit scale to help facilitate cross-compatibility of the modules of a system. For example, a closed-tube rotator module may have a 2-unit length and a 2-unit diameter, where a unit is 30 mm.

(103) An example of a 2-unit length/2-unit diameter closed-tube rotator module **10** is shown in FIGS. **1** and **2**, and is shown reconfigured in FIG. **3B** as a 2-unit length/2-unit diameter 6-way closed-tube rotator hub assembly **101**. These closed-tube rotator modules comprise a rotator receptacle **11** configured for secure demountable engagement with a second module wherein a male end of the second module may rotate 360° within receptacle **11**. The closed-tube rotator modules **10, 100, 101** may comprise a closed-tube housing **15** that provides, in this example, a 2-unit modular length when a rotator receptacle assembly **20** (FIG. **5**) is secured within the closed-tube housing **15** at four threaded tube-end screw slots **18** by four screws **23**. The exemplary rotator receptacle assembly **20** comprises a lock-spring rotator half-socket **21** and a lock-release rotator half-socket **22** that together define: (i) an outer bushing channel **24** for an outer bushing **26**; (ii) an inner bushing channel **28** for an inner bushing **30**; (iii) a pivot-lock channel **32** for an exemplary pivot lock **60**; and (iv) square-nut slots **34** for securing square nuts **36** within the closed-tube housing **15** for alignment with either a retaining lock **50** or a side-mount bore **38**.

(104) In these examples, a square-nut slot **34** is provided for receiving therein a square nut **36** that can threadably secure a retaining-lock set screw **40** coming in through the retaining-lock set screw bore **42** in the closed-tube housing **15** and passing through the nut **36** in to the rotator receptacle assembly **20** where, depending on the set screw's position, the retaining-lock set screw **40** engages a retaining lock **50**. The retaining lock **50** comprises a retaining half-lock with spring receptacles **52** and a retaining half-lock with release button **54**. Springs **56** are engaged within the half-lock with spring receptacles **52** and against the inside of the lock-spring rotator half-socket **21**, thereby pressing the retaining half-lock with spring receptacles **52** towards the center of the receptacle and against the retaining half-lock with release button **54**. Using a tension-adjustment screw knob **58** or other screw driver, the retaining-lock set screw **40** can be securely advanced against the retaining half-lock **52** thereby limiting how far it can move outward from the center of the receptacle against the springs **56**. The retaining lock **50** can be moved by an operator by manually pressing the retaining lock-release button **55** on the retaining half-lock with release button **54** through a release button hole **44** in the closed-tube housing **15**. When the set screw **40** is fully engaged, the retaining lock **50** can no longer be disengaged, therefor preventing the removal of a co-operating male component **70** until the retaining-lock set screw **40** is loosened, as will be described in further detail

below.

(105) Any one of a group of male components **70** situated on a co-operating module of the system may be demountably secured and pivotably engaged within a rotator receptacle **11** of the rotator modules **10**, **151**, **605**, **640**. Referring to FIGS. **1** and **2**, the closed-tube rotator modules **10** may include a male component **70**, a closed-tube housing **15**, a pivot-lock sprocket **74**, and a wide pivot segment **78** which is rotationally co-operative with the outer bushing **26** in a rotator receptacle **11** of another module.

(106) The proximal end of the male component **70** has an octagonal recess **81** whereby it can be fixed to the larger assembly with an octagonal boss **79** (first seen in FIG. **3A**) on the end-face of the wide pivot segment **78**, or in the exemplary male member side-mount assembly **110** (first seen in FIGS. **3A**, **3B**) where the octagonal boss **118** is shown on a wide pivot component **116**. The octagonal-shaped connection points allow for a male component **70** to be reversibly attached in two orientations relative to the supporting module.

(107) As shown in FIG. **2**, a male component **70** may comprise eight prongs **82** in four linear sets of two prongs **82** wherein each set of prongs is spaced equidistantly at 90° intervals around the circumference of the male component **70** whereby the male component **70** may be demountably engaged with receptacles **11**, **211**, **252** (FIGS. **1**, **6**, **8A**, respectively).

(108) When demountably engaged with a rotator receptacle **11**, the outer cylindrical section of the male component **70**, i.e. the narrow pivot segment **84** (shown in FIG. **2**), is rotationally co-operative with the inner bushing **30** of the receptacle **11**. The male component **70** has two collars (distal **87a**, proximal **87b**) defining a neck **88** (FIG. **2**). The leading edge **86** of the distal collar **87a** is chamfered (**86** is referred to hereinafter as a retaining-lock chamfer) and presses back the retaining half-lock with spring receptacles **52** to allow entry of the male component **70** into the receptacle **11** or alternatively into receptacle **211** (FIG. **6**). The half-lock with spring receptacles **52** remains pressed back until the distal collar **87a** and outer four prongs **82** on the male component **70** pass through it after which, the half-lock **52** is aligned with the neck **88** and engages within whereby the tension of the springs **56** co-operating with the half-lock **52** retains the male component **70** within the receptacle **11**. An operator may manually disengage the retaining lock **50** by pressing the release button **55** through the release button hole **44** in the closed-tube housing **15** thereby moving the retaining half-lock with release button **54** inward, thereby pressing the retaining half-lock with spring receptacles **52** outward against the springs **56** thereby disengaging the retaining lock **50** from the neck **88** of the co-operating male component **70**, thereby allowing separation of the co-operating modules.

(109) A retaining-lock set screw **40** may be used to adjust the tension applied by the half-lock **52** with the springs **56** against a neck **88** of a male component **70**. The position of the set screw **40** against the half-lock **52** can be adjusted and secured within a square nut **36** housed within a square nut slot **34** provided therefor in the lock-spring rotator half-socket **21**, using a tension-adjustment screw knob **58** (shown in FIG. **1**) or with another type of screwdriver through a retaining-lock set screw bore **42** provided therefor in the closed-tube housing **15**. The retaining-lock set screw **40** may be adjusted between retracted and engaged positions to provide a range of friction in the pivotable contact between the neck **88** and the retaining lock-half **52**, or alternatively, when fully engaged, to stop rotation of the male component **70** and also to prevent movement of the retaining lock **50** thereby preventing removal of the male component **70** until the set screw **40** is retracted and the half-lock **52** can again be pressed back against the springs **56** to enable removal of the male component **70** from the receptacle **11**.

(110) The neck **88** of the male component **70** may optionally comprise one or more spaced-apart threaded bores **89** to enable engagement of, for example, a side-connector screw **265** with a male/receptacle side-opening joiner module **251** as illustrated in FIG. **8**. For use in the example shown in FIG. **8**, the neck **88** has four equidistantly spaced apart threaded bores **89** thereby providing four positions in which a male component **70** can be fixed in place within a side-opening

joiner receptacle **252**.

(111) According to one embodiment of the present disclosure, a male component **70** may be engaged with a closed-tube housing **15** by a connector screw **90** threadably engaged with a threaded bore at the center of a wide pivot segment **78** as shown in FIGS. **1** and **2**. The assembly of a male component **70** engaged with wide pivot segment **78** is referred to hereinafter as a male member closed-tube end assembly **71**. According to another embodiment of the present disclosure, a male component **70** may be engaged with a wide pivot component **116** and a pivot-lock sprocket **112** to form a male member side-mount assembly **110**. As shown in FIG. **3**, a male member side-mount assembly **110** may be demountably engaged with a closed-tube housing **15** with a bolt **120** passing through a side-mount bore **38** in the housing **15**, or in other modules, to be threadably engaged with a square nut **36** secured within square-nut slot **34** in the rotator half-socket **21** or half-socket **22** at, in this example, up to four out of seven side-mount bore **38** positions (FIGS. **2** and **3**).

(112) According to another embodiment of the present disclosure, the narrow pivot segment **84** of the male component **70** may rotationally cooperate with the inner bushing **30** of a receiving rotator receptacle **11** (FIG. **2**). Furthermore, the cylindrical surface of either a wide pivot segment **78** or wide pivot component **116** may rotationally cooperate with an outer bushing **26** fixed within the receptacle **11** (FIG. **2**).

(113) According to other embodiments of the present disclosure, for example as shown in FIGS. **1-5**, **26**, and **29**, rotator modules **10**, **151**, **605**, **640** may comprise a pivot lock **60** having a pivot-lock indexing peg **62** set within a pivot-lock button **64** for use to demountably engage a rotator module **10**, **151**, **605**, **640** with another module. The pivot lock **60** can be engaged or disengaged by pressing down on the pivot-lock button **64** and lowering its lock-hold tab **65** into or out of a recess in the pivot-lock channel **32**. Then once an operator has manually slid the pivot-lock button **64** to a lock or an unlock position and has released the downward flex applied manually to it, the lock-hold tab **65** returns upward where it holds the pivot lock **60** in place either within the lock's opening or alternatively, moved under into the recess in the pivot-lock channel **32**. In this example, two side teeth on the base of the pivot-lock button **64** assist with holding the pivot lock **60** in place where they protrude into two pairs of corresponding indentations in the sides of the pivot-lock channel **32**, and are flexed inwardly with the sliding force applied by the operator to allow the pivot-lock button **64** to move between the positions.

(114) By engaging the pivot lock **60** in this manner, the indexing peg **62** may extend into, on another module with which its module is being engaged, a pivot-lock sprocket which has around its outer edge sixteen open-sided pivot-lock slots providing sixteen locking positions at 22.5° increments around the male components **70**, wherein the indexing peg **62** reversibly locks the pivotable movement of a male component **70** of the other module within the receptacle **11** of the rotator module. The exemplary male member closed-tube end assembly **71** (FIG. **2**), including features of the closed-tube housing **15**, may comprise a pivot-lock sprocket **74** with pivot-lock slots around the base of the wide pivot segment **78** (FIG. **1A**). Similarly, as shown in FIG. **3B**, a male member side-mount assembly **110** may comprise a pivot-lock sprocket **112** with pivot-lock slots around its outer edge and two small teeth within its open inner circumference, wherewith the pivot-lock sprocket **112** is secured down against the cylindrical body of the module **101** by the wide pivot component **116** having in its concave bottom two retaining slots which correspond to the two teeth in the pivot-lock sprocket **112** which hold the components together as they are secured against the round side of module **101** by a bolt **120** threadably engaged with a square nut (not shown) within the closed-tube housing **15**.

(115) According to some embodiments, the rotator modules disclosed herein may comprise seven side-mount bores **38** positioned at 45° increments around the circumference of the modules except for locations wherein a pivot lock **60** is situated. The positioning of the side-mount bores **38** make it possible to configure assemblies, generically referred to herein as closed-tube rotator hub assemblies **100** with different varying angular orientations and degrees of separation for one or two

or three or four attached male member side-mount assemblies **110** as illustrated in FIG. 3. As shown in FIG. 2, the side-mount bore **38**, located opposite the pivot lock **60**, that aligns with the seam of the two rotator socket-halves **21**, **22** requires a threaded insert within the wall of the closed-tube housing **15** due to the recesses here in the socket-halves required to be open for where corresponding to a square nut channel **170** in embodiments where a rotator receptacle assembly **20** is contained within an extension-tube housing **155**, as shown in FIG. 5.

(116) Some examples of double-receptacle extension-tube rotator modules **151**, **152**, **605** are illustrated in FIGS. 4, 5, and 26 wherein all three modules have a rotator receptacle **11** at each end. Modules **151**, **605** are shown without any mounted male member side-mount assemblies **110** (FIG. 4). Module **152** is shown engaged with two male member side-mount assemblies **110** (FIG. 5) and is referred to herein as a 4-way double-receptacle extension-tube rotator hub assembly **152**, which provides four points of interconnection with other modules of a system assembly.

(117) The double-receptacle extension-tube rotator modules, according to the embodiments of the present disclosure, comprise a rotator receptacle **11** formed by a rotator receptacle assembly **20** having the same components and functionalities as previously described, securely fixed within each end of an extension-tube housing **155** by four screws **23** inserted into four threaded tube-end screw slots **168** within the inner wall of the extension-tube housing **155** (FIGS. 4, 5). According to some embodiments, matching the 2-unit diameter and several other features of the closed-tube housing **15** previously described, the extension-tube housing **155** may have two retaining-lock set-screw bores **162** for adjustment of each receptacle's retaining-lock set screw **40**, two release button holes **164** for manual access to each retaining lock's release button **55**, as well as the plurality of side-mount bores **160** (in the embodiment illustrated in FIGS. 4, 5: two sets of six bores), to match the number and positions of square nuts **36** contained by the housing **155** and receptacle assemblies **20** for reconfigurable attachment of up to four male member side-mount assemblies **110** around the extension-tube housing **155**.

(118) According to other embodiments disclosed herein, male member side-mount assemblies **110** can also be attached at middle points along an extension-tube housing through a plurality of side-mount bores corresponding with the same number of square nuts **36** securely held within the tube housing by a middle square-nut holder having a matching plurality of square-nut slots positioning each square nut in alignment with a side-mount bore. Referring to FIG. 5, middle square-nut holder **180** is positionable during construction, optionally by a threaded positioning-rod (not shown) temporarily engaged at threaded bore **184** to hold and move holder **180**, within extension-tube housing **155** on the inward-facing edges of the housing's square nut channels **170** within the same number of tube rail channels **182** on the sides of the middle square-nut holder **180**, until the holder **180** is aligned with an available set of six side-mount bores **160**. In order to prevent unwanted movement of the middle square-nut holder **180** once it is in position, a short positioning set screw **186** may be inserted into an available side-mount bore **160**, when not engaged by a side-mount assembly **110**. A middle square-nut holder may also include crush ribs on its outer edges to prevent unwanted movement within an extension-tube housing.

(119) In addition to providing engagement with tube rail channels **182**, the square-nut channels **170** at their two positions around the circumference of the extension-tube housing **155** provide an opening within which one or more square nuts **36** can be inserted and are slidable within and along the channels **170**, and thus, may be used for demountable engagement of an additional male member side-mount assembly **110** with a bolt **120** at various positions along the extension-tube housing **155** thereby allowing for a range of unique hub assemblies.

(120) It is to be noted that the closed-tube housings of the closed-tube rotator modules disclosed herein may comprise elongate structural elements be selected from the range of 2 cm to 240 cm, for example 2 cm, 4 cm, 5 cm, 6 cm, 8 cm, 10 cm, 15 cm, 20 cm, 25 cm, 30 cm, 35 cm, 40 cm, 45 cm, 50 cm, 55 cm, 60 cm, 65 cm, 70 cm, 75 cm, 80 cm, 85 cm, 90 cm, 95 cm, 100 cm, 110 cm, 120 cm, 130 cm, 140 cm, 150 cm, 160 cm, 170 cm, 180 cm, 190 cm, 200 cm, 210 cm, 220 cm, 230 cm, 240

cm, and therebetween. An example of a suitable elongate structural element of the closed-tube housings disclosed herein may be a tube having a circular cross-section or an elliptical cross-section or a square cross-section or a rectangular cross-section or a trapezoidal cross-section or a triangular cross-section or a hexagonal cross-section or an octagonal cross-section or a decagonal cross-section or an I-shaped cross-section.

(121) It is to be noted that the extension-tube housings of the double-receptacle rotator modules disclosed herein can be selected from the range of 2 cm to 240 cm, for example 2 cm to 240 cm, for example 2 cm, 4 cm, 5 cm, 6 cm, 8 cm, 10 cm, 15 cm, 20 cm, 25 cm, 30 cm, 35 cm, 40 cm, 45 cm, 50 cm, 55 cm, 60 cm, 65 cm, 70 cm, 75 cm, 80 cm, 85 cm, 90 cm, 95 cm, 100 cm, 110 cm, 120 cm, 130 cm, 140 cm, 150 cm, 160 cm, 170 cm, 180 cm, 190 cm, 200 cm, 210 cm, 220 cm, 230 cm, 240 cm, and therebetween. An example of a suitable elongate structural element of the extension-tube housings disclosed herein may be a tube having a circular cross-section or an elliptical cross-section or a square cross-section or a rectangular cross-section or a trapezoidal cross-section or a triangular cross-section or a hexagonal cross-section or an octagonal cross-section or a decagonal cross-section or an I-shaped cross-section.

(122) It is optional to provide closed-tube housings with lengths from the range of 4 cm to 240 cm with a plurality of equidistantly spaced-apart middle square-nut holders **180** aligned with additional side-mount holes **160** to enable additional options for configuring a variety of demountable engagement options with a plurality of pivot male member side-mount assemblies.

(123) It is optional to provide extension-tube housings with lengths from the range of 4 cm to 240 cm with a plurality of equidistantly spaced-apart middle square-nut holders **180** aligned with additional side-mount holes **160** to enable additional options for configuring a variety of demountable engagement options with a plurality of pivot male member side-mount assemblies.

(124) Joiner Modules

(125) Joiner modules, as disclosed herein, are the components or the modular assemblies of a structural system, configured for demountable assembly with rotator modules or other modules, to assemble a variety of tool-bearing or load-bearing structures and the like, that may be fixed-in-place and stationary, or alternatively, that may be mobile through co-operation with rollers or wheels or castors. Joiner modules may demountably interconnect with one or more of a rotator module, and/or one or more of a tool support module, and/or one or more of a load-bearing module, and/or one or more of a base module, and/or one or more of an end-cap module, as disclosed herein.

(126) Examples of some embodiments of the joiner modules of the present disclosure are shown in FIGS. 6-12. Some embodiments pertain to joiner modules that comprise a joiner receptacle and an opposing male end. Some embodiments pertain to joiner modules additionally comprising an elongate structural element interposed a joiner receptacle and a male end. Some embodiments pertain to joiner modules that comprise two opposing male ends. Some embodiments pertain to joiner modules additionally comprising an elongate structural element interposed the two opposing male ends. Some embodiments pertain to joiner modules that comprise two opposing joiner receptacles. Some embodiments pertain to joiner modules additionally comprising an elongate structural element interposed the two opposing joiner receptacles. A joiner module comprising an elongate structural element may optionally be referred to as an extension-tube joiner module.

(127) It is to be noted that the elongate structural element of the joiner modules may be a tube or a rod having a circular cross-section or an elliptical cross-section or a square cross-section or a rectangular cross-section or a trapezoidal cross-section or a triangular cross-section or a hexagonal cross-section or an octagonal cross-section or a decagonal cross-section or an I-shaped cross-section. The length of a joiner module elongate structural element may be selected from the range of 2 cm to 240 cm, for example 2 cm, 4 cm, 5 cm, 6 cm, 8 cm, 10 cm, 15 cm, 20 cm, 25 cm, 30 cm, 35 cm, 40 cm, 45 cm, 50 cm, 55 cm, 60 cm, 65 cm, 70 cm, 75 cm, 80 cm, 85 cm, 90 cm, 95 cm, 100 cm, 110 cm, 120 cm, 130 cm, 140 cm, 150 cm, 160 cm, 170 cm, 180 cm, 190 cm, 200 cm, 210

cm, 220 cm, 230 cm, 240 cm, and therebetween.

(128) Some embodiments pertain to joiner modules that additionally comprise one or more male member assemblies demountably engaged with an elongate structural support component or element and extending radially therefrom. Such joiner modules may be referred to as a joiner hub module or a joiner hub assembly.

(129) One example of a closed-tube joiner module, which as shown in FIG. 6A may also be referred to herein as a closed-tube joiner hub assembly **201**, comprises a joiner receptacle **211** formed by a joiner receptacle assembly **220** housed within a joiner closed-tube housing **215** having a pivot-lock sprocket **216** and a male component **70** extending outward along the longitudinal axis of the joiner closed-tube housing **215**. A male member side-mount assembly **110** is shown demountably engaged to the side of the joiner closed-tube housing **215** and extending radially therefrom. The joiner module **201** may provide a 90° elbow joint in a utility or structural support assembly, or alternatively, may provide a T-junction in a utility or structural support assembly.

(130) An example of a 5-way closed-tube joiner hub assembly **210** is shown in FIGS. 6B and 7, and comprises a joiner closed-tube housing **215** with a joiner receptacle **211** at one end and a male component **70** at the other end, with three male member side-mount assemblies **110** extending outward radially from the joiner closed-tube housing **215**. The joiner receptacle **211** comprises a joiner receptacle assembly **220** secured to four threaded tube-end screw slots **218** in the joiner closed-tube housing **215** with four screws **23**. The joiner receptacle assembly **220** comprises a lock-spring joiner half-socket **221** and a lock-release joiner half-socket **222** that together define: (i) an outer bushing channel **224** for an outer bushing **26**; (ii) an inner bushing channel **228** for an inner bushing **30**; and (iii) square-nut slots **234** for securing square nuts **36** within the joiner closed-tube housing **215** for alignment with either a retaining lock **50** or a side-mount bore **238**.

(131) It should be noted that the 5-way closed-tube joiner hub assembly **210** shown in FIGS. 6B and 7 may have a 2-unit modular length matching a 2-unit diameter of 60 mm, which is the exemplary system format sizing of 30 mm units referred to herein as unit scale, which is described for demonstrative purposes only and not to be intended to limit the disclosure herein to these values or proportions.

(132) As disclosed herein, a male component **70** of another module of a system assembly may be demountably engaged with a joiner receptacle **211** of the present joiner modules by way of operating the retaining lock-halves **52**, **54** contained within the joiner receptacle assembly **220**. When the male component **70** of another module (in this case, the second module) is inserted into the joiner receptacle **211** of a joiner module, the retaining-lock chamfer **86** on the distal collar **87a** of the male component **70** presses back the retaining half-lock with spring receptacles **52** thereby allowing entry of the male component **70** into the joiner receptacle **211**. The half-lock **52** remains pressed back until the distal collar **87a** and outer four prongs **82** on the male component **70** is passed through to where the half-lock **52** is aligned with the neck **88** of the male component **70** and the tension of the springs **56** engages the half-lock **52** within the neck **88** and against the half-lock with release button **54**. An operator may disengage the second module from the joiner module by pressing the release button **55** through the release button hole **244** in the joiner closed-tube housing **215** thereby moving the retaining half-lock with release button **54** inward resulting in an outward movement of the retaining half-lock with spring receptacles **52** against the springs **56** to where it is disengaged from the neck **88** of the second module allowing demounting of the second module from the joiner module.

(133) A retaining-lock set screw **40** may be used to adjust the tension applied by the half-lock **52** with the springs **56** against a neck **88** of a male component **70**. The position of the set screw **40** against the half-lock **52** can be adjusted and secured within a square nut **36** housed within a square nut slot **234** provided therefor in the lock-spring joiner half-socket **221**, using a tension-adjustment screw knob **58** (shown in FIG. 1) or another type of screwdriver through a retaining-lock set screw bore (not visible in FIGS. 6 and 7) provided therefor in the joiner closed-tube housing **215**. The

retaining-lock set screw **40** may be adjusted between retracted and engaged positions to provide a range of pressure in the contact of the retaining lock-half **52** and the neck **88** of the second module. When fully engaged, the position of the set screw **40** prevents movement of the retaining lock **50** thereby preventing disengagement of the second module until the set screw **40** is retracted and the half-lock **52** can again be pressed back against the springs **56** to enable removal of the second module's male component **70** from the joiner receptacle **211**.

(134) Unlike the rotator receptacle **11** shown in FIGS. **1** and **2**, which provides a secure engagement of a rotator module with a second module whereby a male member assembly of the second module is rotatable 360° within the rotator receptacle **11**, the joiner receptacle **211** of a joiner module provides a securely fixed and un-rotatable engagement of a male member assembly of a second module mounted therein. The example of a joiner receptacle **211** shown in FIGS. **6** and **7** comprises a joiner receptacle assembly **220** having two half-sockets **221**, **222** which form a total of four prong-retaining slots **223** within which the eight prongs **82** of a male component **70** of another module are aligned and fixedly secured upon insertion of the male component **70**. The joiner receptacle assembly **220** additionally comprises an outer bushing **26** and an inner bushing **30**, housed within bushing channels **224**, **228** respectively, that cooperate with the prong-retaining slots **223** to securely engage the male member assembly by its wide pivot segment/component and its narrow pivot segment **84**, respectively, upon insertion into the joiner receptacle **211**.

(135) Providing five points of demountable engagement with up to five other modular components, the 5-way closed-tube joiner hub assembly **210** includes a joiner receptacle **211** within a joiner closed-tube housing **215**, a male component **70** in linear alignment with the joiner receptacle **211**, and three male member side-mount assemblies **110** extending radially outward from the joiner closed-tube housing **215**. The male component **70** in linear alignment with the receptacle is attached at its octagonal recess **81** to the joiner closed-tube housing **215** at the octagonal boss of the housing's wide pivot segment by a connector screw **90** (the octagonal boss and wide pivot segment are not visible in FIGS. **6B**, **7**). Each of the three male member side-mount assemblies **110** are engaged with the joiner closed-tube housing **215** with a bolt **120** passing through the center of the male component **70**, the wide pivot component **116**, and the pivot-lock sprocket **112**, then through the side-mount bore **238** in the joiner closed-tube housing **215**, and threadably engaged with a square nut **36** secured within one of the square-nut slots **234** around the outside of the joiner half-sockets **221**, **222**.

(136) The joiner closed-tube housing **215** may comprise eight side-mount bores **238** positioned at 45° intervals around the circumference of the housing. These bores **238** make available varying angular orientations and degrees of separation for mounting thereon up to four male member side-mount assemblies **110** in various closed-tube joiner hub assemblies. Six of the eight side-mount bores **238** correspond with six square nuts **36** contained within square-nut slots **234**. The remaining two side-mount bores **238** are located adjacent to the seam of the two joiner half-sockets **221**, **222** where threaded inserts are required within the wall of the joiner closed-tube housing **215**, due to the recesses here in the half-sockets for where in alignment with the square-nut channels of an extension-tube housing in the configuration of an extension-tube joiner module, for example, a double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** or a male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **465**, shown in FIG. **17**.

(137) Some embodiments disclosed herein relate to one or more of a group of side-opening joiner modules for use in configuring a utility or structural support system assembly that may require an open-faced or closed side-ways connection from where a male member assembly of a second module can be demountably engaged from the side of the joiner module. An example of a male/receptacle side-opening joiner module **251** is illustrated in FIGS. **8A** and **8B** and has a side-opening receptacle **252** wherein a second module's male component **70**/male member assembly may be securely or releasably engaged.

(138) Male/receptacle side-opening joiner module **251** comprises an extension-tube housing **255**

with a side-opening receptacle component **260** secured to one end with two screws **23** threadably engaged with tube-end screw slots **257**, and a male member extension-tube end assembly **270** secured to the other end by four screws **23** passed through screw holes **278**, provided therefor in a male member tube-end plate **271**, and threadably engaged with four tube-end screw slots **257** in the extension-tube housing **255**. Tube rail channels in both the side-opening receptacle component **260** and the inserted portion of the male member tube-end plate **271** allow each component to be secured in between the inward-facing edges of the opposing square-nut channels **256** of the extension-tube housing **255**.

(139) A male member side-mount assembly **110** for a second module is shown in FIG. **8B** (the second module is not shown) in alignment for insertion into the side-opening receptacle **252** for secure engagement therein. Prong-retaining slots **262** are provided within the side-opening receptacle component **260** corresponding to the shape and alignment of prongs **82** on the male component **70** of an inserted male member assembly to facilitate insertion and removal of that male member assembly of the second module into and out of the side-opening receptacle component **260** and allow for secure engagement therein. For a secure engagement of the co-operating modules, a side connector screw **265** may be inserted through a bore provided therefor in both the extension-tube housing **255** and the side-opening receptacle component **260** (these bores are not visible in FIG. **8B**) and then may be threadably engaged with one of the threaded bores **89** in the neck **88** of the male component **70**. If so desired, a side-opening receptacle cover **268** may also be engaged with the receptacle component **260** to provide a protective closure of the engaged male member assembly. If separation of a side-opening joiner module and a second module is required during use and/or operation of the system assembly, the side connector screw **265** and side-opening receptacle cover **268** may be excluded from the assembly so that the male member assembly of the second module may temporarily remain seated until lifted out of the receptacle or the open receptacle is pointed downward.

(140) The male member extension-tube end assembly **270** provided at the opposite end of the male/receptacle side-opening joiner module **251** in this example illustrated in FIGS. **8A** and **8B** comprises a male component **70** mounted to a male member tube-end plate **271** having a wide pivot segment **274** and a pivot-lock sprocket **272** for demountable engagement with other modules of a system assembly. The male member tube-end plate **271** is secured to the extension-tube housing **255** with four screws **23** through screw holes **278** threadably engaged with screw slots **257** provided therefor in the extension-tube housing **255**.

(141) The outward end-face of the male member tube-end plate **271** may comprise slots which align with the square-nut channels **256** of the extension-tube housing **255** whereby, in a completed module, square nuts **36** may be inserted through the end-face of the tube-end plate **271** into a square-nut channel for demountable engagement to a male member side-mount assembly **110**.

(142) In this example, up to four male member side-mount assemblies **110** may be attached radially from the extension-tube housing **255** by a bolt threadably engaged through one of the six side-mount bores **258** with a square nut **36** securely held within the tube housing by a middle square-nut holder **180** that has six square-nut slots that position each square nut **36** in alignment with a side-mount bore **258**. The middle square-nut holder **180** is positioned during construction of the module inside extension-tube housing **255** upon the inward-facing rails of the housing's square-nut channels **256** within the tube rail channels **182** as shown in FIG. **8B**. In addition to providing the inward-facing rails, the square-nut channels **256** provide channels within which one or more square nuts **36** are slidable and may provide a threadable engagement point for mounting of a male member side-mount assembly **110** with a bolt **120** at operator-selected positions along the extension-tube housing **255**, thereby allowing for configuration of a wide range of unique hub assemblies.

(143) According to some aspects, the length of the extension-tube housing **255** may be selected from the range of 2 cm to 240 cm, for example 2 cm, 4 cm, 5 cm, 6 cm, 8 cm, 10 cm, 15 cm, 20

cm, 25 cm, 30 cm, 35 cm, 40 cm, 45 cm, 50 cm, 55 cm, 60 cm, 65 cm, 70 cm, 75 cm, 80 cm, 85 cm, 90 cm, 95 cm, 100 cm, 110 cm, 120 cm, 130 cm, 140 cm, 150 cm, 160 cm, 170 cm, 180 cm, 190 cm, 200 cm, 210 cm, 220 cm, 230 cm, 240 cm, and therebetween. In constructions of side-opening joiner modules that have extension-tube housings with lengths of 4 cm or longer, it may be desirable to insert one or more middle square-nut holders **180** within the length of the extension-tube housing **255**. It is optional, during construction of longer side-opening joiner modules, to temporarily engage a middle square-nut holder **180** with a threaded positioning-rod at threaded bore **184** to move and hold in place the middle square-nut holder **180** while it is aligned with and secured at a selected set of side-mount bores **258**. In order to prevent unwanted movement of the middle square-nut holder **180** once it is in position, a short positioning set screw **186** may be inserted into an available side-mount bore **258**, when not engaged by a side-mount assembly **110**. A middle square-nut holder may also include crush ribs on its outer edges to prevent unwanted movement within an extension-tube housing.

(144) Another embodiment of the present disclosure relates to double-male joiner modules having two male ends for demountable engagement with receptacles of the other modules of a utility or structural support system.

(145) One example of a double-male joiner module **281** is shown in FIGS. **9A** and **9B** for use to demountably engage two adjacently positioned receptacles of two modules of a utility or structural support system, as may be required. The double-male joiner module **281** comprises a double-male component **282** with both sides having a pivot-lock sprocket **284** and a wide pivot segment **286** with an outward-facing octagonal boss **288** having a threaded bore therethrough. It is to be noted that the proximal ends of male components **70** have an octagonal recess **81** configured for sliding engagement with an octagonal boss **288**. Each male component **70** is secured to the double-male component **282** by mounting onto an octagonal boss **288** and then inserting a connector screw **90** through the male component **70** to be threadably engaged with the threaded bore provided in the octagonal boss.

(146) Another embodiment relates to a double-male joiner module having an extension-tube housing interposed two male end assemblies. An example of a double-male extension-tube joiner module **291** is shown in FIGS. **10A** and **10B** and comprises an extension-tube housing **295** engaged with a male member extension-tube end assembly **270** at each end.

(147) The extension-tube housing **295** has a pair of opposing longitudinal square-nut channels **296** and four equidistantly spaced-apart longitudinal screw slots **297** extending between the ends of the extension-tube housing **295**. One or more middle square-nut holders **180** may be inserted into the interior of the extension-tube housing **295** wherein the tube rail channels **182** of a middle square-nut holder **180** may slide along the inward-facing surfaces of the pair of longitudinal square-nut channels **296** of the extension-tube housing **295**. In this example, up to six square nuts **36** may be inserted into the same number of slots in the middle square-nut holder **180** for demountable engagement with up to four male member side-mount assemblies **110** through the side-mount bores **298**. A positioning set screw **186** can be used to maintain the positioning of the middle square-nut holder **180** when not engaged by a male member side-mount assembly **110**. Also for this purpose, the middle square-nut holder **180** may comprise crush ribs around its outer edges to grip the inside surface of the extension-tube housing **295**. Male member side-mount assemblies **110** may also be mounted at various positions along the extension-tube housing **295** within the square-nut channels **296**, thereby allowing for a range of unique hub assemblies.

(148) The double-male extension-tube joiner module has a male member extension-tube end assembly **270** secured to each end of the extension-tube housing **295** with screws **23** extending through screw holes **278** in the male member tube-end plate **271** and threadably engaged with tube-end screw slots **297** within the inner wall of the extension-tube housing **295**. The octagonal bosses **275** are slidably engaged with an octagonal recess at the proximal end of each male component **70** after which a connector screw **90** is inserted through the distal ends of the male components **70** and

threadably engaged with a threaded bore provided therefor in the octagonal bosses **275**.

(149) Another example of a multi-engagement point joiner hub assembly of the present disclosure is shown in FIGS. **11A**, **11B**. A 6-way extension-tube joiner hub assembly **301** may comprise the double-male extension-tube joiner module **291** shown in FIGS. **10A**, **10B**, to which is mounted four male member side-mount assemblies **110** extending outwardly from the extension-tube housing **295**. Two opposing male member side-mount assemblies **110** are mounted to the extension-tube housing **295** by threadable engagement of bolts **120** inserted therethrough, with square nuts **36** that have been inserted into the square-nut channels **296**. The other two opposing male member side-mount assemblies **110** are mounted to the extension-tube housing **295** by threadable engagement of bolts **120** inserted therethrough, and then through side-mount bores **298**, into square nuts **36** housed by a middle square-nut holder **180** positioned inside the extension-tube housing **295** (not visible in FIGS. **11A**, **11B**).

(150) Another embodiment of the present disclosure relates to cross-format double-male adapter joiner modules that facilitate engagement of modules with male assemblies and receptacles with different dimensions, and optionally, system format characteristics such as the number of prongs on the male ends, into a single utility or structural support assembly. An example of a double-male adapter joiner module **311** is shown in FIGS. **12A** and **12B**.

(151) Double-male adapter joiner module **311** comprises: (i) a male member tube-end plate **271** to which a male component **70** is mounted by a connector screw **90** inserted through the distal end of the male component **70** and threadably engaged with a threaded bore provided therefor in the octagonal boss **275** of the male member tube-end plate **271**, (ii) an adapter joiner component **312**, having a (iii) alternative male member component **314**, which has a different diameter and length and number of prongs than male component **70**, for demountable engagement into a receptacle of a different system format. The male member tube-end plate **271** is secured to the adapter joiner component **312** by insertion of screws **23** through screw holes **278** to be threadably engaged with screw slots **316** in the adapter joiner component **312**.

(152) Male Member Mount Modules

(153) Further embodiments of the present disclosure relate to a variety of male member mount modules, which may include male member side-mount bracket modules and male member mounting block modules. Particularly, the male member side-mount bracket modules provide, among other functions, unique hub assemblies which may be included in a system assembly for demountably fixed or rotatable/slidable engagement of mounted male member assemblies, on an elongate tubular support element at special angular orientations, which can be rapidly repositioned without requiring removal of modules mounted thereon. Male member mounting block modules, for their part, provide for a variety of all-male hub assemblies.

(154) An example of a 2-way 30° side-mount bracket module **320** is shown in FIG. **13A** that is demountably engageable with an elongate tubular support element, such as an extension-tube housing. The 30° side-mount bracket module **320** comprises a 30° angle male member mount bracket **322** and a clamp bracket **328** that may be securely engaged to an elongate tubular support element (not shown) by placing the male member mount bracket **322** and clamp bracket **328** around the elongate tubular support element, inserting clamp bracket screws **329** through bores provided therefor in the clamp bracket **328**, and threadably engaging the screws **329** with bores provided therefor in the 30° angle male member mount bracket **322**. It is to be noted that the combination of the male member mount bracket **322** and clamp bracket **328** may be referred to as a “collar clamp”. The 30° angle male member mount bracket **322** is provided with a pair of threaded bores (not visible in FIG. **13A**) for engagement therewith of up to two male member side-mount assemblies **110** which extend outward each at a 30° angle from the module's center, or at a 60° angle (**326**) between a pair. The 30° angle male member mount bracket **322** may be provided with one or more mount screw holes **323** to enable threadable engagement of a 30° side-mount bracket module **320** to an elongate tubular support element with a mount screw **325** threadably engaged, for

example, with a square nut contained in an extension-tube housing's square-nut channel or middle square-nut holder **180**.

(155) An example of a 4-way multi-angle side-mount bracket module **330** is shown in FIG. **13B** and which comprises a pair of opposed multi-angle male member mount brackets **335** for encircling and clamping to an elongate tubular support element, such as an extension-tube housing, wherein each bracket **335** has a pair of opposed bracket screw bores **336** at each end of the bracket **335** for receiving therethrough and threadably engaging bracket screws **338** in the corresponding bores in the opposing bracket. At least one mount screw hole **331** is provided along the centre point of the longitudinal axis of each bracket **335** (three holes **331** are shown in FIG. **13B**) for receiving therein a mount screw **332**, and on the opposite side, a washer **339**, for engagement of the bracket **335** on an elongate tubular support element. Each multi-angle male member mount bracket **335** has two opposed sets of three spaced-apart threaded bores **334** for threadable engagement with a bolt **120** to demountably secure thereto two outwardly extending male member side-mount assemblies **110**. Each set of three spaced-apart threaded bores **334** allows for mounting of a male member side-mount assembly **110** at an angle of 30° or 45° or 60° from the module's center, or at an angle of 60° or 90° or 120° between a pair of male member side-mount assemblies **110** mounted to the bracket **335**. In this example, the two 45° bores **334** provide their mounting position at a unit scale extension, of for example 30 mm, from the bracket's **335** inner mounting circumference.

(156) A single multi-angle male member mount bracket **335** may be used in isolation, if mounted to an extension-tube housing using one or more mount screws **332**, or when used as a stand-alone special-angle hub.

(157) An example of a 2-way 90° offset side-mount bracket module **340** is shown in FIG. **13C** and comprises a 90° angle offset male member mount bracket **341** having a mount screw hole **342** accessible by a mount screw **325** and a screwdriver (not shown) through a screw-access opening **346** to enable securing of the mount bracket **341** to an elongate tubular support element, such as an extension-tube housing (not shown), with a mount screw **325**. This example of the 90° offset side-mount bracket module **340** has mounted two opposing male member side-mount assemblies **110** extending longitudinally that will be positioned in parallel to an elongate tubular support element to which the side-mount bracket module **340** may be demountably engaged. It is to be noted that the combination of any of the male member mount brackets **322**, **341**, **335**, and the like with any of clamp brackets **328**, **335**, and the like, or with plate wedges **445** and the like, may be referred to as a “collar clamp”.

(158) An example of a 1-way 45° offset side-mount bracket module is shown in FIG. **13D** and comprises a cylindrical 45° offset male member mount bracket **351** demountably engaged with an example of a male member flat-mount assembly, which may be provided in a system assembly, as disclosed herein, to allow for demountable engagement of a male member to a flat surface. Male member flat-mount assembly **361** comprises (linked by a bolt **120**) a male component **70**, as previously described, mounted on another example of a wide pivot component **367**, which at its other end is engaged with another example of a pivot-lock sprocket **362** for reversible locking with a pivot lock **60**, which interfaces with a flat surface, described in further detail below.

(159) There is a flat surface provided at one end of the cylindrical mount bracket **351** that has four peg holes **354** for positioning of and engagement with pivot-lock sprocket **362** by its four pegs **365**. The wide pivot component **367** having four connector teeth **368** extending from one end, is inserted into slots **366** provided therefor in the pivot-lock sprocket **362** (best seen in FIG. **14A**). The other end of the wide pivot component **367** has an octagonal boss **369** for extending into the octagonal recess provided therefor in the male component **70**. The male assembly **361** is secured to the cylindrical mount bracket **351** by a bolt **120** inserted through bores provided therefor in the male component **70**, the wide pivot component **367**, and the pivot-lock sprocket **362** (through central bore **363**), and then threadably engaged with a central bore **353** provided therefor in the end-face of the cylindrical mount bracket **351**. At the opposite end of the bracket **351** there is an angled

concave surface that is configured to matingly engage the outer surface of an elongate tubular support element, such as an extension-tube housing, not shown. Through the opposite side and out of the concave surface there is a mount screw hole **352** provided therefor to receive therein on the inside a washer **339**, and from the other side, a mount screw **332** for demountable engagement of the bracket with an elongate tubular support element, such as an extension-tube housing having a square nut within a channel or housed by a middle-square nut holder within. According to further embodiments, a cylindrical mount bracket may have a concave surface at an angle other than 45° relative to the flat-mount surface. According to further embodiments, a cylindrical mount bracket may have side-mount bores around its circumference provided for sideways mounting of male member side-mount assemblies.

(160) An example of an elbow male member mounting block module **355** is shown in FIG. **14A** and comprises a 2-way elbow male member mounting block **370** having two end surfaces, in this example at 90° from each other, and a male member flat-mount assembly **361** engaged with each end surface. Each end surface of the mounting block **370** has four peg holes **372** for positioning of and engagement with a pivot-lock sprocket **362** of a male member flat-mount assembly **361**. A male member flat-mount assembly **361** is engaged with an end surface of the mounting block **370** with a bolt **120** inserted through the bores of the assembly **361** and threadably engaged with a central bore **371** provided therefor in the end surface of the mounting block **370**. According to further embodiments, a 2-way elbow male member mounting block may have an angle other than 90° between the end surfaces.

(161) An example of a cube male member mounting block module **356** is shown in FIG. **14B**. The 6-way cube male member mounting block **373** has six symmetrical out-facing surfaces for engagement with up to six male member flat-mount assemblies **361** (two male member flat-mount assemblies **361** are shown in FIG. **14B**). Each out-facing surface of the mounting block **373** has four peg holes **375** for receiving and engaging therein the pegs **365** of a pivot-lock sprocket **362**, and a central threaded bore **374** for threadable engagement with a bolt **120** to securely mount thereto a male member flat-mount assembly **361**.

(162) An example of a triangular male member mounting block module **357** is shown in FIG. **14C** with a 5-way triangular mounting block **376** having five faces for demountable engagement with up to five male member flat-mount assemblies **361** (two male member flat-mount assemblies are shown in FIG. **14C**). Each face of the triangular mounting block **376** has four peg holes and central threaded bore for receiving therein and engagement therewith a male member flat-mount assembly **361**.

(163) An example of a pyramidal male member mounting block module **358** is shown in FIG. **14D** and comprises a 4-way pyramidal mounting block **377** with four symmetrical out-facing surfaces, each configured for demountable engagement with a male member flat-mount assembly **361** as described for the cube male member mounting block module **356** shown in FIG. **14B**. The pyramidal male member mounting block module **358** is shown in FIG. **14D** demountably engaged with two male/receptacle side-opening joiner modules **251** (shown in FIG. **8**), and with two additional male/receptacle side-opening joiner modules **251** with two corresponding male member flat-mount assemblies **361** shown exploded in their alignment for demountable engagement.

(164) An example of a hexagonal male member mounting block module **359** is shown in FIG. **14E** comprising an 8-way hexagonal mounting block **378** with six side faces configured for demountable engagement with up to six male member flat-mount assemblies **361**, and a top-surface face and a bottom-surface face wherein each face is configured for demountable engagement with one male member flat-mount assemblies **361**, with a bolt passing through the central bores of the assembly **361** and threadably engaged with a central bore in the mounting faces of the mounting block **378**.

(165) An example of an octagonal male member mounting block module **360** is shown in FIG. **14F** comprising a 10-way octagonal mounting block **379** with eight side faces configured for

demountable engagement with up to eight male member flat-mount assemblies **361**, and a top-surface face and a bottom-surface face wherein each face is configured for demountable engagement with one male member flat-mount assembly **361**.

(166) An example of a 5° increment adjustable male member mount module **380** is shown in FIGS. **15A**, **15B** comprising a male-mount half housing **381** and a rotation-adjustment half housing **386** whereon male member assemblies are demountably engaged. The inward-facing end surfaces of the male-mount half housing **381** and rotation-adjustment half housing **386** are provided with intermeshing teeth **388** that enable repositionable engagement of the rotation-adjustment half housing **386** in 5° increments relative to the male-mount half housing **381**, allowing for the adjustment and setting, in precise 5° increments, of the angular separation between the two lower male member flat-mount assemblies **361** which are shown in FIG. **15B** exploded from the brackets **390a**, **390b**, to which they are mounted at peg holes **394** with a connector bolt **120**, threadably engaged with the central bore **393**. Prior to engagement with the flat-mount assemblies **361**, brackets **390a**, **390b** are mounted to male-mount half housing **381** and rotation-adjustment half housing **386**, respectively, by a screw **391** through their bores **392** to be threadably engaged with a mounting bore **389** (in FIG. **15B**, visible only on the rotation-adjustment half housing **386**). Each of their male member flat-mount assemblies **361** can then be mounted. An adjustment screw **385** is then passed through a through-hole **383** in the male-mount half housing **381** and threadably engaged with a threaded bore **387** on the inward-facing end of the rotation-adjustment half housing **386**. It is optional that a flat-mount assembly **361** is additionally mounted to the outward face of the male-mount half housing **381** at peg holes **384** and through-hole **383**, but therefore requiring a longer version of adjustment screw **385** than if not included in the assembly. At this stage, an adjustable hub assembly has been created, which by loosening the adjustment screw **385**, the teeth **388** of the housings **381**, **386** can be disengaged, allowing the relative positions of the housings to be rotated and then re-engaged at one of the 5° increments by re-tightening the adjustment screw **385**. As described above, the angular separation between the two male assemblies **361** mounted on the brackets **390a**, **390b** can be set in 5° increments, from a maximum of 180°, to a minimum of 60° where the two brackets will come to meet.

(167) As shown in FIG. **15**, an optional male member flat-mount assembly **361** can be mounted to the outward face of the rotation-adjustment half housing **386** with a bolt **120** threadably engaged with the outer excess of center bore **387**. In addition, optionally, two of another example of, as disclosed herein, a male member side-mount assembly are shown mounted to side-mount bores **382** on the circumference of male-mount half housing **381**. According to embodiments, male member side-mount assembly **395** comprises the previously described male component **70** mounted to the wide pivot component **367** mounted to another example of a pivot-lock sprocket **396** having wide pivot component slots **399** whereby component **367** may be engaged, at which time assembly **395** may be demountably engaged with a side-mount bore **382**, or of another module, by a bolt **120** passing through the outer components **70**, **367**, and through central bore **397** in pivot-lock sprocket **396** to be threadably engaged with a side-mount bore. As mounted in FIG. **15**, the side-mount assemblies **395** can provide for a variety of adjustable hub assemblies, however, it should be noted that in their use, they limit the extent to which the angular settings of the 5° increment adjustable male member mount module **380** may be adjusted, from where the bracket **390b** on the rotation-adjustment half housing **386** meets bracket **390a**, to where it comes to meet the nearest male member side-mount assembly **395** on the male-mount half housing **381**.

(168) Tool Support Modules and Load Support Modules:

(169) Baseplate Modules

(170) Some embodiments of the present disclosure relate to baseplate assemblies for incorporation into a utility support system to enable demountable engagement with a tool such as a camera or microphone or sound equipment and other types of tools into a utility support system. For example, the baseplate assemblies disclosed herein can be for mounting thereon camera-mount plates and

camera accessories such as matte-box holders, focus-pull devices, and the like. The baseplate assemblies may comprise a screw mount or a clip or a dovetail plate or a box or a tray or a basket and the like for demountably engaging a variety of tools and loads.

(171) An example of a baseplate assembly **400** suitable for demountable engagement with a film camera, high-definition video camera, DSLR, other device, or additional interfacing mount-plate or dovetail plate, is shown in FIGS. **16A**, **16B** (perspective view, exploded perspective view, respectively). This example of a baseplate module **400** comprises a baseplate body assembly **402** having a baseplate top plate **402a** secured to a baseplate bottom plate **402b** by baseplate screws **406**. One or more mounting screws **404** (sized as necessary) is/are provided through slots in the baseplate body assembly **402**, to threadably engage one or more mounting bores provided therefor in the base of the camera or other device or mounted component.

(172) In this example, the baseplate top plate **402a** and bottom plate **402b** together define three mounting bracket slots **408** which allow for one to three offset cooperating mounting brackets **410** to be secured to the body assembly **402** in selected positions to engage and support therein varying sizes of cameras or other suitable load. Each mounting bracket **410** comprises: (i) a bracket arm **412** that is configured for sliding engagement with a mounting bracket slot **408** in the baseplate body assembly **402**, (ii) a bracket side plate **415** engaged with the bracket arm **412** and extending upward therefrom, and (iii) a male member plate assembly **420** that is demountably engaged with the outward-facing surface of the bracket side plate **415**.

(173) The male member plate assembly **420** comprises a male component **70** engaged with a mounting plate **422** having an outward-facing wide pivot segment **424**, octagonal boss **425**, pivot lock sprocket **423**, and a flat inward-facing plate surface that can be demountably engaged with the outward-facing surface of the bracket side plate **415** at selected positions with screws **428** inserted through screw holes **426** in the mounting plate **422** and threadably engaged with threaded bores **416** provided therefor in the bracket side plate **415**.

(174) An inward-facing support plate **417** with a support pad **418** secured thereon is mounted to the inward-facing surface of the bracket side plate **415** with screws **419**. The support pads **418** may be positioned directly against a camera or other load, positionable as described in further detail below, to secure the camera or other load in supplementation of, or instead of, the mounting screws **404**.

(175) The bracket arm **412** has a plurality of equidistantly spaced-apart threaded bores **413** therethrough along the longitudinal axis of the arm **412**. A selection of threaded bores **413** are aligned by the operator to correspond with bores **405** in the baseplate bottom plate **402b** for threadable engagement with baseplate screws **406** inserted through the bores **405**. The distance of the secure outward extension of the bracket arm **412** can be adjusted by selection of the spaced-apart threaded bores **413** for threadable engagement with baseplate screws **406** inserted through the bores **405**, in this example to produce varying sized system format unit scale widths across the total width of the modular assembly **400** between opposed male member plate assemblies **420**.

(176) It should be noted that the male member plate assemblies **420** shown in this example are demountably engageable with a receptacle component of a rotator module or a rotator assembly disclosed herein, or with a receptacle component of a joiner module or a joiner assembly disclosed herein, or with other assemblies as disclosed herein having a receptacle component. It should be noted that, in this example, the offset of the centers of the bracket side plates **415** from the centers of the bracket arms **412** may align, when using adjacent mounting bracket slots **408**, the two opposed side plates **415** and mounted male member plate assemblies **420** to provide a single axis between opposed male member plate assemblies **420**. As shown, a baseplate assembly may also include a male member plate assembly **420** demountably engaged with the underside of the baseplate body assembly **402** to provide an additional axis for pivotable or fixed engagement of the baseplate assembly **400** within a system assembly.

(177) Another example of a baseplate module suitable for demountable engagement with, for example, a camera is shown in FIGS. **17A**, **17B** (perspective view, exploded perspective view,

respectively). This example of a baseplate assembly **430** comprises a tool mount plate **435** engaged with a double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** sandwiched between two male/receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **465**. A pair of multi-angle male member mount brackets **335**, as previously described in reference to FIG. **13B**, are fitted side-by-side against the lower longitudinal section of the double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** and engaged with two pairs of plate wedges **445** with four bracket screws **338** inserted through holes **447** in the plate wedges **445** and then, threadably engaged with bores provided therefor in the multi-angle brackets **335**. In the opposite direction, four bracket screws **338** may be inserted through bores **336** and threadably engaged with bores in the undersides of plate wedges **445**. When the bracket screws **338** are loosened, engagement with the joiner module **460** is slidable or pivotable on the given length of joiner module **460**. For a secure hold, the bracket screws **338** can be tightened.

Optionally, the multi-angle bracket(s) **335** can be engaged directly with a joiner module or rotator module with one or more mount screw(s) **332** threadably engaged with square nuts **36** slidably engaged within the corresponding module's square-nut channel.

(178) The tool mount plate **435** is secured to the plate wedges **445** with screws **442** inserted through plate screw holes **440** and threadably engaged with threaded bores **446** in the plate wedges **445**. A tool or other device, for example, a camera, or camera mount plate for supplementary interfacing with a camera or camera accessories, may be secured to the tool mount plate **435** with mounting screws **436** inserted into tool-mounting slot **437** and then threadably engaged with one or more mounting bores provided therefor in the base of the tool or device.

(179) A male member flat-mount assembly **361** is engaged with a male mount slider component **450** which is then clamped to a male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **465** by a multi-angle bracket **335** with bracket screws **338** inserted through bores **336** provided therefor in the multi-angle bracket **335** and then threadably engaged with bracket screw bores **456** in the male mount slider component **450**, and through opposing bores **456** in the slider component **450** threadably engaged with a second pair of opposed bores **336** in the multi-angle bracket **335**. The clamped-together slider component **450** and multi-angle bracket **335** may be repositioned on the joiner module **465** by loosening the bracket screws **338**, selecting a new position, and then re-tightening the bracket screws **338**.

(180) The position of the clamped-together male mount slider component **450** and multi-angle bracket **335** along the male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **465** may be additionally secured and adjusted as follows. A pair of square nuts **36** is inserted into each of the opposed longitudinal channels **466**. Two mount screws **332** are inserted through mounting holes **331** provided therefor in the multi-angle bracket **335** and are threadably engaged with one of the pairs of square nuts **36** (a pair of washers **339** is interposed the inner face of the multi-angle bracket **335** and the extension-tube joiner module **465**). Two mount screws **453** are inserted through mounting holes **452** provided therefor in the male mount slider component **450** and are threadably engaged with the other pair of square nuts **36** (a pair of washers **339** is interposed the inner face of the male mount slider component **450** and the extension-tube joiner module **465**). The mount screws **453** and the mount screws **332** are loosened after which, the clamped-together male mount slider component **450** and multi-angle bracket **335** may be slid along the male/receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **465** to a selected position, after which, the screws **453** and **332** are re-tightened. Optionally, only one pair of screws **453**, **332** may be used in conjunction with only one square-nut channel **466**.

(181) It should be noted that a baseplate assembly or other modular assembly may use a male mount slider component **450** in isolation, or clamped together in a pair in the same manner as described above in combination with a multi-angle bracket **335**. It should also be noted that a male mount slider component **450** may by its width provide a unit scale extension, of for example 30 mm, of its central male member mounting bore **454** out from the circumference of the module to which it is mounted. In the example of baseplate assembly **430**, this feature provides a unit scale

width across the module.

(182) Positioned with peg holes **455** and secured with a bolt threadably engaged with central bores **454**, the male member flat-mount assemblies **361** extending toward the center of the baseplate assembly **430** from the male mount slider components **450**, are demountably engaged with receptacles at the opposite ends of the double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460**. In assemblies wherein screws **332** and square nuts **36** are not engaged with the longitudinal channel in the underside of joiner module **460**, the supported tool mount plate **435** may be rotated about the double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** to a desired position by slightly disengaging the bracket screws **338** with a tool inserted through access bores **441** provided therefor in the tool mount plate **435**, and through bracket screw bores **336** provided therefor in the multi-angle brackets **335**, and then rotating the tool mount plate **435** to a desired position and then reengaging the bracket screws **338**. Alternatively, for an open and intermittently lockable 360° pivotable connection of the tool mount plate **435** to the outer assemblies, the joiner module **460** may be replaced with a double-receptacle rotator module such as the previously cited example rotator module **151** shown in FIG. 4.

(183) The baseplate assembly **430** may be securely engaged within a larger utility or structural support assembly by one or both of the two joiner modules' **465** receptacles, or by one or both of the two joiner modules' **465** male member extension-tube end assemblies **270**, or by the addition of male member side-mount assemblies **110**, **395** (not shown) to one of the joiner modules **465** or multi-angle brackets **335**.

(184) Tray Modules

(185) Some embodiments of the present disclosure relate to tray modules that can be incorporated into utility system assemblies. An example of a tray module assembly **470** is shown in FIGS. **18A**, **18B** (perspective view and partially exploded perspective view, respectively) comprising a tray bottom **471** which has an orifice **472** at each corner. It is to be noted that a tray bottom may be rectangular or square or trapezoidal or triangular or pentagonal or hexagonal or heptagonal or octagonal in shape. An example of a square-shaped tray bottom **471** is shown having four orifices **472** at each corner for insertion and reversible engagement of extension-tube joiner modules or extension-tube rotator modules of varying lengths, which may optionally act as a system assemblies' structural corner posts. Adjacent to each orifice **472**, tray bottom **471** additionally comprises collar bores **473** whereby a collar **474** is demountably secured to the tray bottom **471** with collar screws **476** passed through the collar bores **473** into threaded bores in the collar **474**.

(186) In this example of a tray module **470**, there is provided four of a second example of a double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **475** (here longer than joiner module **460** shown previously in FIG. 17) passed through the combined four collars **474** and tray bottom **471**. The extension-tube joiner modules **475** can be demountably secured therein within the center of each collar **474** by collar screws **476** passed through side-facing bores in the collar, and threadably engaged with square nuts **36** placed within the longitudinal square-nut channels **477**, or alternatively, housed by a receptacle socket assembly or middle square-nut holder within a module's extension-tube housing. The collars **474** may additionally comprise side-facing threaded bores at which side panels **478** can be demountably secured with side panel screws **479** passed through bores in the side panels **478** to be threadably engaged with the collars **474**. For added reinforcement, optionally the top ends of the extension-tube joiner modules **475** and side panels **478** are secured to four additional collars **474**, as shown. Wherein an assembly in which the collars **474** are engaged along the square-nut channels **477** of the corner modules, a tray bottom **471** and side panels **478** assembly may be raised or lowered on its corner modules by loosening the collar screws **476**, selecting a new position, and then retightening the collar screws. It is to be noted that tray bottoms and tray sides disclosed herein may also be referred to as "flat sheet stock".

(187) Such tray modules can be incorporated into utility system assemblies for use to hold and transport equipment, tools, materials, supplies, and the like around a worksite or other location, or

alternatively, for use in shelving systems or staging platforms. The tray modules may be pivotably engaged into a utility system assembly where mounted on rotator modules, thereby providing a load-dumping function, if so desired. The tray modules can also be incorporated into platform assemblies or table assemblies or workstation assemblies.

(188) Table Modules

(189) Some embodiments of the present disclosure relate to table and desk and shelf module assemblies that can be assembled using some of the modules disclosed herein, and may also be used to assemble staging platforms. An example of a desk assembly **480** is shown in FIG. **19A** and comprises a desk top **481** with an example of a double-receptacle side-opening joiner module **488** engaged at each corner. It is to be noted that a desk top or a table top may be rectangular or square or trapezoidal or triangular or pentagonal or hexagonal or heptagonal or octagonal or circular or oval in shape. If so desired, a shelf **482** may be provided engagement with, for example, a pair of a second example of double-receptacle side-opening joiner modules **489** mounted to the desk top **481**. An example of how a double-receptacle side-opening joiner module **488** may be engaged with a desk top **481** is shown in FIG. **19B**. A recess, not visible in FIG. **19B** but identical to recess **483** on the top surface of the desk top **481**, is provided on the bottom surface of the desk top **481** at each corner. A mounting plate **484** with a central threaded bore **485** is inserted into the recess and securely mounted to the desk top **481** with, for example, five screws **487** inserted through bores **486** provided therefor in the mounting plate **484**. It should be noted that a mounting plate may be circular or oblong or triangular or square or rectangular or trapezoidal or hexagonal or octagonal in shape and providing varying numbers of screw bores **486**.

(190) A male member flat-mount assembly **361** is mounted to the plate **484** with a mounting bolt threadably engaged with the threaded bore **485**. Then, the male member flat-mount assembly **361** is inserted into the receptacle in the end of a double-receptacle side-opening joiner module **488** and secured in place as described for side-opening joiner module **251** in reference to FIG. **8B**.

Alternatively, there may be provided for mounting one or more of a rotator module, or one or more of a joiner module as described, for example, double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** in reference to FIG. **17B**. If a shelf **482** is to be added, then a plate **484** is inserted into a recess **483** provided therefor in the desk top surface and secured in place with screws **487** inserted through bores **486**. A male member flat-mount assembly **361** is mounted to the plate **484** with a mounting bolt threadably engaged with the threaded bore **485**, after which, the male member flat-mount assembly **361** is inserted into a receptacle in the end of a double-receptacle side-opening joiner module **489**, or alternatively, a receptacle of another double-receptacle module. A pair of plates **484** and male member flat-mount assemblies **361** are mounted to the bottom of the shelf **482** and secured into, as shown, receptacles in the other ends of double-receptacle side-opening joiner modules **489**.

(191) Lighting Mount Modules

(192) Some embodiments of lighting mount modules that provide attachment means for demountable engagement of lighting equipment or other similar types of equipment into some utility system assemblies, are shown in FIGS. **20A** to **20D**. One example of a lighting mount module **490** is shown in FIGS. **20A**, **20B** and comprises an extension-tube housing **492** having a male member extension-tube end assembly **270** secured at one end. A spigot **498** is threadably engaged with a spigot mount plate **494** by a screw **497** inserted through a threaded bore **496** in the spigot mount plate **494**. The spigot assembly is then mounted to the other end of the extension-tube housing **492** with screws threadably engaged with screw bores provided therefor in the extension-tube housing **492**.

(193) Another example of a lighting mount module **500** is shown in FIGS. **20C**, **20D** and comprises a spigot-adapter male member component **501** comprising a wide pivot segment **507** at one end to which is secured a male component **70** with a screw **90** threadably engaged with a bore in the octagonal boss of the wide pivot segment **507**. The spigot-adapter male member component **501**

has a pivot-lock spigot **506** situated about its midpoint, and a spigot receptacle **503** at its other end. A spigot **502** is inserted into the spigot receptacle **503** and secured in place with a set screw **504** inserted through screw bore **505** and then tightened with a tension-adjustment screw knob **58** or other screwdriver.

(194) Base Modules:

(195) Rail-Rolling Modules

(196) Some embodiments of the present disclosure pertain to rail-rolling modules and assemblies that are configured for demountable engagement of, for example, a motion-picture camera that can be conveyed along a rail track system in filmmaking or videography. Similar assemblies may be used to convey along a rail track system other devices, tools, equipment, materials, properties, and the like around a worksite or other location. Some examples of rail-rolling modules and assemblies are shown in FIGS. **21A**, **21B**, and **22**.

(197) An example of a rail-rolling module **510** (FIGS. **21A**, **22**) comprises two pairs of spring-suspension roller assemblies **514** engaged with a carriage plate **512** and has an upward-extending male member plate assembly **420**. Each roller assembly **514** comprises an axle block **516** with downward-extending ends with bores therethrough for receiving axle bolts **520**. A washer is placed onto each axle bolt **520**, then a roller **518**, another washer, and then a lock nut which rotationally secures the roller **518** to the axle block **516**. One end of a spring block **522** is rotationally attached approximate one end of the axle block **516** with a suspension bolt **524**. The other end of the spring block **522** has a recess for receiving therein a spring tension plate **528** and a spring **530** biased against the other end of the axle block **516**. The tension of the spring can be adjusted by tightening or loosening a spring tension set-screw **526** provided therefor in the spring block **522**. The pair of spring-suspension roller assemblies **514** are mounted to opposing ends of the carriage plate by screws (not shown) through bores in the spring block **522** into threaded bores provided therefor in the top of the carriage plate **512**. Approximate the center of the carriage plate, a spacer plate **532** is optionally mounted by screws (not shown) whereon a male member plate assembly **420** comprising a male component **70** engaged with a mounting plate **422**, is mounted to the top surface of the spacer plate **532**, completing the rail-rolling module **510**. It is optional to additionally attach to the rail-facing surface of the carriage plate **512**, a friction-pad plate **540** with a rail-facing friction pad **542** to modulate the speed of motion of the rail-rolling module **510** along a rail track system, if so desired. The friction-pad plate **540** is attached to the carriage plate **512** with a pair of partially-threaded tension adjustment knobs **544** threadably engaged at their upper section with bores provided therefor in the carriage plate **512**. Around each knob's **544** unthreaded lower section (which is passed partially through an unthreaded bore in the friction pad plate **540**), there is provided, from top to bottom, an upper retaining ring **548** held within an upper neck (adjacent below the threaded section) in the knob shaft, and interposed that ring and the plate **540** a spring **546** which, when the knob **544** is extended downward by turning, the upper retaining ring **548** applies pressure on the spring against the plate **540**, thereby increasing the tension of the friction pad **542** against a rail (not shown). The remaining section of the knob shaft passes through the plate **540** whereby a second lower retaining ring **548**, held within a lower neck of the shaft, prevents separation of the plate **540** from the knobs **544**.

(198) A rail-rolling module may alternatively comprise, in place of the two spring-suspension roller assemblies **514**, two fixed roller assemblies **535** (described in further detail below), when spring-loaded suspension of the module upon a rail is not desired.

(199) An example of a rail-surround rolling module assembly **537** (FIG. **21B**, **22**) comprises a second carriage plate **512** (having engaged at each end a fixed roller assembly **535**), mounted to a rail-rolling module **510** by at least one side plate **538**, and optionally, using two side plates **538**. The fixed roller assemblies **535** each comprise an axle block **536** to which is secured a pair of rollers **518** as described for the spring-suspension roller assemblies **514**. The two axle blocks **536** are mounted with screws (not shown) onto the second carriage plate **512**, which is then mounted

with screws (not shown) to one end of the side plate(s) **538**. A rail-rolling module **510** is engaged with the opposite end of the side plate(s) **538** thereby forming a rail-surround rolling module assembly **537**. The rail-surround rolling module assembly **537** is particularly useful for safely and securely conveying camera equipment, or other device, tool, equipment or supported load, along rail track systems that are not horizontally flat, including vertical or inclined rails, and one or more curved rails. It is optional to modify a rail-surround rolling module assembly **537** by mounting a male member plate assembly **420** to a second spacer plate **532** and/or to the one or two side plates **538**, for up to four outwardly extending male member assemblies provided for interconnection of the modular assembly within a structural support system. It is optional to exclude the from one to four spacer plates **532** and engage the male member plate assemblies **420** directly to the carriage plates **512** and side plates **538**, if so desired, resulting in varying widths between opposed male member plate assemblies **420**, allowing optionally for modular unit scale widths or other total widths.

(200) Additional rail-surround rolling modules may alternatively comprise assemblies with four spring-suspension roller assemblies **514** or four fixed roller assemblies **535**. Also, additional rail-surround rolling modules may alternatively comprise assemblies with one, two, or no friction pad plates **540** and friction pads **542**. Additionally, a rail-surround rolling module may be assembled in a configuration of the inverse of assembly **537** wherein the carriage plates **512** and roller assemblies **514** or **535** are faced outward, connected centrally by one of a double-receptacle module demountably engaged with the now inward-facing male member plate assemblies **420**, and engaged upon two opposed rails.

(201) Wheel Modules

(202) Other embodiments of the present disclosure relate to wheel modules which may provide a transporting or mobility feature within a utility system assembly. The various wheel modules and wheel module assemblies include steerable assemblies or open 360° pivotable caster assemblies or caster-style assemblies.

(203) One example of a wheel module assembly **550** is shown in FIGS. **23A**, **23B** and comprises a wheel-axle/receptacle side-opening joiner module **555** to which a wheel **552** is rotationally engaged with an axle bolt **554**. The side-opening joiner module **555** comprises an extension-tube housing **255** with opposed longitudinal square-nut channels **256** and a middle square-nut holder **180** housed therein, a side-opening receptacle component **260** with a side-opening receptacle cover **268**, and a wheel-axle tube-end component **551** engaged with mounting screws. The wheel-axle tube-end component **551** has a central threaded bore **551a** and two offset threaded bores **551b**. The axle bolt **554** may be threadably engaged with the central threaded bore **551a** or alternatively, one of the two offset threaded bores **551b**, wherein the offset bores **551b** allow for a wheel module assembly to act as a caster.

(204) Another example of a wheel module according to the present disclosure is a caster wheel module assembly **560** illustrated in FIGS. **23C**, **23D** wherein a pivoting or fixed caster wheel **568** is threadably engaged with a bore provided therefor in a mount component **562**. A male member flat-mount assembly **361** is engaged with the mount component **562** by its pivot-lock sprocket's **362** pegs within the peg holes **566** and the threaded engagement of a bolt **120** with threaded bore **564**.

(205) Foot Modules

(206) An example of a leveling foot module **580** is illustrated in FIGS. **24A** and **24B** (perspective and exploded perspective views, respectively) and comprises a male member flat-mount assembly **361** engaged with a mount component **562** in the same manner as described for caster assembly **560** in reference to FIG. **23D**. An adjustable foot component **581** has a foot end **583** from which extends a threaded leveling rod **582** with which a nut **584** is threadably engaged. The adjustable foot component **581** is threadably engaged with a bore provided therefor in the mount component **562** until the nut **584** abuts the base of the component and may be tightened. The distance that the foot end **583** stably extends from the mount component **562** is adjustable by threading nut **584**

along the threaded leveling rod **582** toward or away from the foot end **583** prior to threadably engaging the threaded leveling rod **582** with the bore in the mount component **562**.

(207) An example of a foot plate module **585** is shown in FIG. **24C** and comprises a foot plate **586** having threaded bores **587** about the centre of the foot plate **586** to which, a male member plate assembly **420** is mounted by threadable engagement of screws **428** inserted through bores in the mounting plate **422** into bores **587**.

(208) Pivotal Support Modules

(209) An example of a pivotal support module **590** is shown in FIGS. **25A** to **25C** and comprises a male member plate assembly **420** secured to a pivot bracket **592** with mounting plate screws **428** inserted through bores provided therefor in the mounting plate **422** and the pivot bracket **592** and then threadably engaged with lock nuts **593**. A pivotal pad component **594** with opposing threaded bores **595** is inserted into the pivot bracket **592**, and secured in a desired position by threadable engagement of knobs **598** with the threaded bores **595** (FIGS. **25A**, **25B**). Washers **599** may be slipped over the threaded portions of knobs **598** before they are threadably engaged with threaded bores **595** to facilitate ease of loosening and tightening the knobs into and out of the pad component **594** when rotatable adjustment of the position of the pad component **594** is desired. The pivotal support module **590** is shown rotatably engaged with a suction-cup component **596** in FIG. **25C** for demountable engagement with glass or another smooth surface.

(210) Weight Modules

(211) An example of a weight module assembly **600** is shown in FIGS. **26A**, **26B** and comprises weight components **602** demountably engaged with another example of a double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **605** with an extension-tube housing **606** having a pair of opposing longitudinal square-nut channels **608** for slidable engagement therein of a plurality of square nuts **36**, as described for double-receptacle extension-tube rotator modules **151** and **152** in reference to FIGS. **4** and **5**. The inner surface of a first weight component **602** is abutted to the extension-tube housing **606** and a bolt **604** is inserted into an outer bore **603a** provided therefor in the weight component **602** and then threadably engaged with a square nut **36** housed within the square-nut channel **608**. A second bolt **604** is inserted into the other outer bore **603a** provided therefor in the first weight component **602** and then threadably engaged with a second square nut **36** housed within the square-nut channel **608**. A second weight component **602** is abutted to the extension-tube housing **606** opposite the first weight component **602** and threadably engaged with square nuts **36** housed in the opposite square-nut channel **608** with two bolts **604** inserted through bores **603a** in the second weight component **602**. Alternatively, one or a pair of weight components **602** may be mounted through center bore **603b** with a bolt **604** passed through a side-mount bore of an extension-tube housing to be threadably engaged with a square nut held by that module's receptacle assembly or middle square-nut holder. It is optional to similarly threadably engage one or more additional weight components **602** to the extension-tube housing **606** if a heavier counter-balance or base weight is desired for the weight module assembly **600**.

(212) Telescoping Extension Modules

(213) An exemplary telescoping extension module **610** is illustrated in FIGS. **27A**, **27B**, and **27C** (perspective, exploded perspective, and longitudinal cross-sectional view, respectively) and generally comprises an extension-tube housing **612** having a male member tube-end plate **271** to which is mounted a male component **70**. The other end of the extension-tube housing **612** is fitted with a telescoping assembly comprising a rod-retaining component **614** which is mounted to the end of the extension-tube housing **612** with four screws **23**. A rod-retaining plate **616**, with a center bore for receiving therethrough a threaded rod **620**, is mounted against the inner-facing surface of the rod-retaining component **614** and to, with screws **619**, the inner-facing surface of an adjustment collar component **618**, the inner section of which passes through the center of the rod-retaining component **614**. The collar component **618** and plate **616** securely but rotationally sandwich the rod-retaining component **614** which secures the assembly within the extension-tube housing with

the screws **23**. The adjustment collar component **618** has a threaded bore therethrough which threadably engages the threaded rod **620**. The distal end of the threaded rod **620** has a narrower diameter threaded portion **621** that is inserted through a bore provided therefor in a spacer plate **622** and secured thereto by threadable engagement with a washer and lock nut **624**. A male member plate assembly **420** (See FIG. **16B** and related description for reference) is mounted to the spacer plate **622** by screws **428** inserted through bores provided therefor in the mounting plate **422** and threadably engaged with threaded bores provided therefor in the spacer plate **622**.

(214) An operator may extend the male member plate assembly **420** away from the extension-tube housing **612** by rotating clockwise the adjustment collar component **618**, which advances outwardly the threaded rod **620** and mounted male member plate assembly **420** until a desired outward extension of the male member plate assembly **420** is achieved. An operator may reversely retract the male member plate assembly **420** by rotating the adjustment collar component **618** in a counter-clockwise direction. When an approximate desired length of the rod extension is achieved, the male member plate assembly **420** and threaded rod **620** may be rotated a small amount in either direction to properly orient the mounted male component **70** and corresponding receptacle module (not shown) where required.

(215) End-Cap Modules:

(216) The following examples of end-cap modules, shown in FIGS. **28** to **33**, provide a variety of structural end component functionalities for uses including as hand grips or feet or bumpers or landing pads or general protective closures of a system assembly's exposed male assemblies or receptacle assemblies.

(217) An example of a grip end-cap module **625** that may be optionally used as a hand grip or a foot or a bumper is illustrated in FIGS. **28A** to **28E**, and comprises a handle grip component **626** and an outer sleeve **631** that rotationally cooperates with the handle grip component **626**. The handle grip component **626** comprises at one end a semi-circular end-cap portion **627**, a middle elongate hand grip portion **628**, and at the other end an inner sleeve **629**. In this example, four prong-retaining slots **630** are provided in the form of recesses within a cavity within the hand grip portion **628** that may receive and secure a corresponding number of linear sets of prongs of a co-operating module's male component **70** (not shown). When in an open position as shown in FIG. **28D**, a co-operating module's male member assembly including male component **70** can be inserted into the grip end-cap module **625** after which, the outer sleeve **631** can be rotated into the closed position as shown in FIG. **28E**, whereby its retainer tabs **632** overlap the prong-retaining slots **630** thereby securing the male component **70** by securing its prongs **82** (shown for example in FIGS. **1**, **2**) within the prong-retaining slots **630**.

(218) Another example of an end-cap module is a shell end-cap module **635** illustrated in FIGS. **29A**, **29B** that is mounted on a male/receptacle extension-tube rotator module **640**. The shell end-cap module **635** comprises a pair of matching half-shell caps **636** that are demountably engaged with the male component **70** of the male/receptacle extension-tube rotator module **640** with screws **637** inserted through bores **638** provided therefor in the half-shell caps and threadably engaged with threaded bores **89** in the neck of male component **70**.

(219) An example of a female dome pad end-cap module **641** is illustrated in FIGS. **30A** and **30B**, and comprises a female dome pad **642** having a collapsible framework **643** with a central orifice **645**. A female dome mounting plate **646** is mounted to the framework **643** with screws **648** inserted through bores **647** provided therefor in the mounting plate **646** and threadably engaged with threaded channels or threaded inserts provided therefor in the framework **643**. The female dome mounting plate **646** has an orifice **649** that is aligned with the orifice **645** in the framework **643**. The orifices **649**, **645** are sized to slidingly but frictionally engage the shell end-cap module **635** that is engaged with male/receptacle extension-tube rotator module **640** (shown in FIG. **29**) or another module.

(220) An example of a male dome pad end-cap module **650** is shown in FIGS. **30C**, **30D** and

comprises a male dome pad **652** having a collapsible framework **653**. A male member flat-mount assembly **361** is mounted with a bolt to a male dome mounting plate **654** at a threaded bore **656** and peg holes **657**. The male dome mounting plate **654** is mounted to the framework **653** with screws **648** inserted through bores **658** in the mounting plate **654**, and then threadably engaged with threaded channels or threaded inserts provided therefor in the collapsible framework **653**.

(221) Some embodiments of the modules disclosed herein include seat end-cap modules that can be incorporated into a utility system apparatus configured for a ride-along dolly setup, or alternatively, in stool or bench assemblies. An example of a seat module **660** is shown in FIGS. **31A** and **31B**, and comprises a seat pad **662** to which a male member plate assembly **420** is mounted by screws **428** inserted through bores provided therefor in the mounting plate **422**, and then threadably engaged with threaded bores (not visible in FIG. **31**) provided therefor in the seat pad **662**.

(222) An example of a bumper end-cap module **670** is shown in FIGS. **32A**, **32B** mounted on a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** with a laterally extending male member side-mount assembly **110** (first seen in FIG. **3A**). A bumper component **672** is slipped over the wide pivot segment **78** of the rotator hub assembly **100** and secured in place by a screw **674** inserted through an orifice provided therefor in the bumper component **672** and then threadably engaged with the threaded bore of the octagonal boss **79** extending upward from the wide pivot segment **78**.

(223) A variety of additional end-cap components according to some embodiments of the present disclosure are illustrated in FIGS. **33A** to **33F**. One example of a soft end-cap component **680** is shown in FIGS. **33A** to **33C** and comprises a soft semi-spherical dome component **688** into which are engaged four inserts **686** with threaded bores. An elongate leg component **681** with an integral mount plate **682** having four bores **683** therethrough is mounted to the dome component **688** with four screws **685** inserted through the four bores **683** and then threadably engaged with the four inserts **686** within the dome component **688**. The soft end-cap component **680** may be engaged, for example, with the receptacle component of a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100**, as shown in FIG. **33C**. When in use in a side-opening receptacle, the component **680** may be securely engaged by a screw threadably engaged with threaded bore **689**.

(224) An example of a hard end-cap component **690** useful for covering and protecting any unused receptacle in a rotator module or joiner module incorporated into any utility system assembly according to the present disclosure, is shown in FIGS. **33D**, **33E**. This example of a hard end-cap component **690** has a flat outward-facing surface **693** with a pull-tab extending across the surface **693** and an elongate downward-extending leg component **691** with a radial retaining-lock chamfer **692** which, when the hard end-cap component **690** is inserted into a receptacle of a rotator receptacle assembly **20** or joiner receptacle assembly **220**, presses back a co-operating retaining half-lock with spring receptacles **52** until passed through the half-lock whereby the hard end-cap component **690** is secured within the receptacle until the retaining lock **50** is released. FIG. **33E** shows the hard end-cap component **690** engaged with the rotator receptacle assembly of a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100**.

(225) A simple flat end-cap component **695** shown in FIG. **33F** can be secured to an open end of any type of extension-tube housing disclosed herein. The flat end-cap component **695** has four bores **696** around its periphery through which screws **23** may be inserted and threadably engaged with threaded screw slots **698** provided at one end of an exemplary extension-tube housing **697** engaged with a male member extension-tube end assembly **270** at its other end.

(226) Unit Scale

(227) The exemplary modules disclosed herein may be configured with various materials over a range of sizes to facilitate assembly of the utility systems and support structures for use in a variety of applications. For ease-of-use and system-wide modular interconnectivity and cross-compatibility, a modular unit scale can be used across all modules of a system format. In the construction of various embodiments, the unit scale can have varying sizes depending on the intended use of the modular system. The sizing and proportions as stated and illustrated is for

descriptive purposes only, informing the relative function and compatibility of the interconnecting modules between one another, and not to be intended to limit any modules of the present disclosure to these values or proportions.

(228) According to some embodiments of the present disclosure, a suitable system format has tube modules with a unit scale standard of a 2-unit diameter, where a unit may equal, for example, 30 millimeters. Although receptacles **11**, **211** and a complimentary male member assembly **71**, **110**, **270**, **361**, **395**, **420** may be longer than 2 units, closed-tube modules **10/201** comprise the closed-tube housings **15/215** which provide for a 2-unit modular unit scale length facilitating hub assemblies having a 2 unit by 2 unit cubed modular unit scale, wherein the receptacle assemblies **20**, **220** overlap within the hollow center of the wide pivot segments of the closed-tube housings **15/215**. According to some embodiments, exemplary rail-rolling modules **510** and rail-surround rolling module assemblies **537** can provide up to a 2-way or a 4-way unit scale configuration, respectively, wherein male member plate assemblies **420** attached to co-operatively sized spacer plates **532** combine to give, for example, a 6-unit modular width between the male member plate assemblies **420** across the rail-rolling modules **510**, **537** allowing for their parallel configurability with other modules of the same system format.

(229) By use of a unit scale across the modules of a system format, calculating and configuring the parts needed to reach an end-use assembly is facilitated. Also in the instance of a series of extension-tube modules, for example, providing the length upon which a rail-rolling module **510**, **537** may travel, the unit scale lengths may provide to the operator a visual guide of distance travelled, whether by the points of connection, or the modules' side-mount bores that may be included along the length of their extension-tubes, and which may also provide connection points for an end-cap module, for example, to be positioned as a stopper, for example, at a desired position along an extension-tube module rail track assembly.

(230) Kits

(231) According to some embodiments disclosed herein, a group of one or more of the various types of modules disclosed herein may be provided together in a kit for assembly into specified types of modular utility system assemblies or support structures for various functional requirements. Irrespective of the end-use system assembly or the type or number of modules, kits of the present disclosure may additionally comprise, or be packaged with, instruments or tools for assisting with the assembly of the system, and/or hard copy or software based instructions for assembling the same.

Customizable Assemblies

(232) The modular units of the present disclosure can be interconnected into a wide variety of utility system assemblies and support structure assemblies that can be designed for a wide variety of applications. In this way, a utility system or support structure can be customized for a particular application using a selected combination of interconnected modules of a given system format, or, using an adapter joiner module **311** or other fastener, modules of multiple system formats. The broad range of configurability allows systems to be assembled in a wide range of sizes and functional design for a broad range of end-user requirements. For example, it is contemplated that the modules of the present disclosure can be interconnected to form utility systems or support structures that include, without limitation, carts, dollies, tracks, cranes, lifts, stands, racks, tables, workstations, seating, bed-frames, shelving, storage, staging, railings, partitions, toy systems, and the like. Optionally, a system assembly may be combined with third party tools, mechanisms, and systems for varying end-use requirements.

(233) According to embodiments, the modules disclosed herein can be selected and interconnected to assemble a plurality of customized tool/load support assemblies which can be configured for use in, for example, filmmaking and/or videography and/or still photography applications, including but not limited to, camera, microphone, and lighting positioning and mobility support systems, and in other embodiments, as carts and stands for other equipment and properties, in variety of

industries or household applications.

(234) To gain a better understanding of the embodiments disclosed herein, the following examples of utility system assemblies and support structure assemblies are described.

EXAMPLES

(235) To further illustrate the versatility of the modules in assembling a variety of utility system assemblies and support assemblies such as carts, dollies, tracks, cranes, lifts, stands, racks, tables, workstations, seating, bed-frames, shelving, storage, staging, railings, partitions, toy systems, and the like, examples of assemblies are provided to demonstrate the various multifunctional aspects of the modular components described herein. Examples 1 through 10 as illustrated in FIGS. **34** to **43**, are configured for use with various types of cameras. However, the illustrated assemblies may be alternatively used for other types of devices such as microphones, lighting, telescopes, lasers, measuring and surveying tools, and the like. Example 11 shown in FIG. **44**, is configured for use with industrial lighting. Examples 12 through 14 shown in FIGS. **45** to **47**, are configured for use as various types of utility carts for transportation of various types of materials, supplies, equipment, and the like. The modules disclosed herein may also be configured into assemblies for use as furniture or for storage as shown in FIG. **48**.

Example 1: Crab-Steering Dolly System

(236) FIG. **34** shows a perspective view of an example of a crab-steering dolly system **700** configured with some of the modules and assemblies disclosed herein, and is designed to provide a trackless operator-controlled crab-steering assembly for conveyance of a camera or other device about a film set or other location. It should be noted that, in this example, referring to the “back” or “rear” means the side of the assembly facing toward in the drawing view, where an operator steering the dolly system would stand, and “front” or “forward” means the side of the assembly facing away in the drawing view. The crab-steering dolly **700** comprises two sub-assemblies wherein the first sub-assembly is a pivotable and rotatable device support structure supported by a pair of rail-surround rolling module assemblies **537**, and the second sub-assembly is a steerable dolly framework provided with: (i) an elongate rail assembly on which the rail-surround rolling modules **537** may travel, (ii) a pair of crab-steering wheel modules **550** at each corner, and (iii) a steering assembly for pivotable control of the wheel modules.

(237) The device support sub-assembly comprises a baseplate assembly **400** to which a camera or other screw-mounted device can be mounted. To the right side of the baseplate assembly **400** is engaged a pan/tilt/jib operating handlebar assembly comprising a 6-unit length double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **151** and a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** capped with a hard end-cap component **690** and with a downwardly extending grip end-cap module **625** to enable an operator's hand control of the baseplate's direction and position. Extending from the left side of the baseplate module **400** is a 4-unit length male/receptacle side-opening joiner module **251** which attaches to a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** to provide an intermittently lockable adjustable-tension 360° device-tilt pivot point controllable with the handlebar assembly to the right of the baseplate. A grip end-cap module **625** is engaged with the hub assembly's **100** left-facing male member for an additional handgrip. Downwardly extending from the rotator hub assembly **100** is a 10-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **710**, which can be locked or provide an off-center 360° device-pan pivot point where met by another rotator hub assembly **100**, to which is mounted a 6-unit length double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** followed by another closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100**, having a bumper component **672** engaged with its upward-facing wide pivot segment, and where met below by a 3-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **720**, provides an intermittently lockable adjustable-tension 360° device-pan pivot point centered below the camera or other pointed device, with the ability to adjust the pivot tension using a tension-adjustment screw knob **58**.

(238) Under joiner module **720**, a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** has engaged on both sides two additional of the same (each having mounted a grip end-cap module **625**) where from two 12-

unit length double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **475** extend down to each a rotator hub assembly **100** (there inwardly providing a jib-tilt pivot point for the assembly above) engaged centrally to a stack of two additional rotator hubs **100** (there providing a jib-pan pivot point for the assembly above). The jib-tilt and jib-pan may be controlled using the grip end-cap module **625** mounted to the end of an 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **730** by a zero-unit length double-male joiner module **281** (not visible). The joiner module **730** also has mounted a counterbalancing weight module assembly **600**.

(239) Below the two above cited stacked rotator hubs **100**, the device support structure is mounted to the rail-surround rolling module assemblies **537** via a 6-unit length double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module where from each side a closed-tube rotator hub assembly is each mounted atop a rail-surround rolling module assembly **537**, thereby allowing for small tracking movements relative to the lower dolly assembly, in this example, running along two parallel 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **740** which are engaged centrally at each end via closed-tube rotator hub assemblies and a 6-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460**, where from downwardly a side-mounted 4-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **750** followed by a closed-tube rotator hub assembly engage the above device support structure and rail assembly to the steerable dolly sub-assembly.

(240) The steerable dolly sub-assembly provides a chassis structure upon which the device support sub-assembly is supported and engaged by the rail-surround rolling module assemblies **537** with the rail assembly. The chassis assembly has at its center a 4-way closed-tube joiner hub assembly **201** from where extends in all four directions four extension-tube joiner modules, the longest being an 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **730** at the center to the back of the assembly, where here a 4-way closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** attaches upwardly to the rail assembly and to each side a 12-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **475**, leading to the two back corners of the chassis. Extending from the central 4-way closed-tube joiner hub assembly **201** toward the front is a 12-unit joiner module followed by a 4-unit joiner module which engages the rail assembly at the front. Extending from each of the sideward faces of the central joiner hub assembly **201** are two 12-unit joiner modules leading to the front two corners of the chassis assembly.

(241) At each corner of the chassis assembly is engaged a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100**, where on each downwardly is engaged a 6-unit male/receptacle extension-tube rotator module **640** providing the corresponding wheel module assemblies **550** with a directional pivot point. Engaged below each of these rotators **640** is a 4-way closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** at the center of the pairs of wheel modules **550**. Extending off the back of each of these hub assemblies is a 6-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460**, met by another rotator hub assembly **100**, wherefrom extends upwardly a 6-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **151**, which provide pivot points of the steering assembly.

(242) To each of the upward-extending back rotator modules **640** are attached in series, a rotator hub assembly **100**, a 2-unit double-male joiner module **291**, and another rotator hub assembly **100**. To each of the upward-extending front rotator modules **640** are attached a 4-unit double-male extension-tube joiner module **756** and a rotator hub assembly **100**. On the left and right side of the dolly, an 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **730** interconnects the steering assembly's top rotator hub assemblies for the forward and the rear rotator modules that are interconnected to the wheel modules **550**. A pair of 12-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **475** extend inward from the lower rotator hub assemblies **100** atop the rear upward-extending rotator modules **640** and are engaged with a another configuration of a 4-way closed-tube joiner hub assembly. Extending back from the joiner hub assembly is a weight module assembly **600** on a 6-unit double-receptacle joiner module. Extending upward from the joiner hub assembly is a 12-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **754** that is engaged with a 4-unit double-male extension-tube joiner module **756** that has three grip end-cap modules **625**. The

sub-assembly described in this paragraph comprises the steering assembly by which an operator can steer the crab-steering dolly **700** while pushing or pulling by the grip end-cap modules **625**. In this example, there is enabled an approximate 140° turning radius of the wheels, by the force applied by an operator to the steering assembly, where pushing the assembly forward and to the left will point the wheel modules **550** toward the right, and vice versa, forward and to the right redirecting them to point towards the left.

Example 2: Vertical Rail-Tracking Dolly System

(243) An example of a vertical rail-tracking dolly system **760** is shown in FIG. **35**, and may be used to provide a stable support for controllably moving a mounted device such as a still camera or a video camera or a film camera in vertically upward and downward motions during moving or still image captures. The wheel modules enable an operator to push or pull the vertical rail-tracking dolly system **760** as desired while operating the mounted device.

(244) The vertical rail-tracking dolly system **760** comprises two sub-assemblies wherein the first sub-assembly is a dolly framework provided with a pair of wheel modules **550** at each corner and a vertical elongate rail structure on which rail-surround rolling module assemblies **537** may travel, and the second sub-assembly is a pivotable and rotatable camera support structure with a pair of rail-surround rolling module assemblies **537** for travelling up and down along the vertical elongate rail structure provided therefor on the dolly framework.

(245) The dolly framework sub-assembly is configured with a first pair of spaced-apart 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **730** that are side-mounted at their ends to a second pair of spaced-apart 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **730** that are engaged at their ends with a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** fitted with a hard socket-cap component **690**. Extending downward from each rotator hub assembly **100** is a 6-unit male/receptacle extension-tube rotator module **640**, providing the directional pivot point of the dolly system's wheel modules **550** that are side-mounted on two sides of a rotator hub assembly **100** at the base of each extension-tube rotator module **640**. In this example, the wheels **552** are bolted to the wheel module's **550** wheel-axle/receptacle side-opening joiner module **555** at corresponding axle offset threaded bores **551b** (not visible), so that these wheel module assemblies will act as large casters and rotate naturally into directional alignment with the directional force exerted by the operator to the dolly assembly. As shown in FIG. **35**, extending from a central third side of the rotator hub assembly, the wheel module assemblies include a weight module assembly **600** side-mounted to a joiner module having a flat end-cap component **695**.

(246) The vertical elongate rail structure comprises two rails wherein each rail consists of, at the lower end, an 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **730** engaged with an upper 18-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **765**. The lower ends of the rail structure are side-mounted at the longitudinal square-nut channels of the first pair of joiner modules **730** provided horizontally. The upper ends of the rail structure have inserted hard socket-cap components **690** for protective enclosure of there the two receptacles.

(247) The second sub-assembly, i.e., the pivotable and rotatable camera support structure, comprises a baseplate assembly **400** to which a camera or other screw-mounted device can be mounted. To the left side of the baseplate assembly **400** (in the view shown in FIG. **35**) is engaged a pan/tilt/jib operating handlebar assembly comprising a first double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **151** and a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** capped with a hard socket-cap component **690** and with a downwardly extending grip end-cap module **625** to enable an operator's hand control of the baseplate's direction and position. Extending from the right side of the baseplate assembly **400** is a male/receptacle side-opening joiner module **251** which is engaged with a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** to provide an intermittently lockable adjustable-tension 360° tilt-axis whereby the baseplate assembly **400** is controllable by the handlebar assembly to the left side of the baseplate assembly. A grip end-cap module **625** is mounted to the outward male member assembly of the rotator hub assembly **100** for a supplementary grip point. Extending downward

from the rotator hub assembly **100** is a 10-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **710**, which may provide an off-center pan-axis where met at its base by a closed-tube joiner hub assembly **201**, from which is side-mounted a first double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** which in turn is engaged with a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** having a bumper component **672** engaged with its upward-facing wide pivot segment, for protection of the camera or other device where it may inadvertently come to meet the hub assembly by rotation upon its 360° tilt-axis. The rotator hub assembly **100** provides the baseplate assembly's intermittently lockable adjustable-tension pan-axis where met by a 3-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **720** which extends downward from the rotator hub assembly and is side-mounted to a second double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460**. A pair of 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **730** is engaged with the opposite ends of the second joiner module **460**, and rotationally engaged with the opposite ends of a second rotator module **151**, and engaged with a third joiner module **460**. A counterbalancing weight module assembly **600** is side-mounted near the bottom end of each of the pair of double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **730**. One end of another 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **730** is side-mounted to the rotationally engaged second rotator module **151** and its other end is side-mounted to a third rotator module **151**. Another extension-tube joiner module **730** is side-mounted to the opposite side of the third rotator module **151** by one end, and has a counterbalancing weight module assembly **600** mounted to its opposite end. A pair of rotator hub assemblies **100**, with hard end-cap components **690** and outward grip end-cap modules **625**, are engaged with receptacles in the opposite ends of the third rotator module **151**, whereby the upper section of the support assembly may pivot up and down, and the extended vertical section of the assembly may remain vertical if so desired by rotation upon the second rotator module **151**. Below the pair of rotator hub assemblies **100**, a pair of double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **460** are engaged and then mounted upon a pair of joiner hub assemblies **201** interconnected by another double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460**. The rail-facing receptacles of the pair of joiner hub assemblies **201** have mounted therein rail-surround rolling module assemblies **537**.

(248) The rail-surround rolling module assemblies **537** are slipped around the vertical elongate rail structure configured on the dolly framework sub-assembly, and can be moved upward and downward therealong by an operator using the grip end-cap modules **625** provided therefor mounted to the sides of the pair of rotator hub assemblies **100** engaged with the third rotator module **151**, and mounted to the sides of the rolling module assemblies **537**. A pair of female dome pad end-cap modules **641** may be side-mounted to the middle horizontal double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** of the second sub-assembly and to the corresponding 18-unit extension-tube joiner module **730** of the first sub-assembly to cushion camera movement as the rail-surround rolling module assemblies **537** travel to the bottom of the vertical elongate rail structure.

Example 3: Lateral Mounted Rail-Tracking Dolly System

(249) An example of a lateral mounted rail-tracking dolly system **770** is shown in FIG. **36**. This type of assembly configuration can be used to provide a horizontal rail system that can be securely fixed in between two opposite stable vertical supports such as two walls or alternatively, for example, inside a vehicle between two of its doors or windows. A device support assembly engaged with one or more rail-surround rolling module assemblies **537** (or optionally, rail-rolling modules **510**), can be controllably moved back and forth along the horizontal rail system by an operator.

(250) In this example, the horizontal rail system comprises a 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **740** demountably engaged at one end with a pivotable support module **590** having mounted therein a pad component **594**. The other end of the joiner module **740** is engaged with a telescoping extension module **610** that is mounted to a pivotable support module **590** having mounted therein a pad component **594**. The horizontal rail system can be securely mounted in place between two vertical support surfaces with the extendable or retractable engagement by the

telescoping extension module **610** with the two surfaces. A similar alternative assembly, not shown, may be engaged vertically between two horizontal support surfaces, where may be required.

(251) In this example, the baseplate assembly **430** illustrated in FIG. **17** is side-mounted to a 3-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **720** at the upper end of each 6-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **465**. The downward-facing wide pivot segment of each of the joiner module's **465** male member tube-end assembly **270** is engaged with a bumper component **672** (the male components **70** there shown in FIG. **17** are here excluded). The outer male ends of the 3-unit joiner module's **720** are each engaged with a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100**. A downward-extending grip end-cap module **625** and left-facing bumper component **672** is engaged with the rotator hub assembly **100** on the left side of the baseplate assembly **430** while the rotator hub assembly **100** on the right side of the baseplate assembly **430** is engaged with a right-facing bumper component **672** and with a downward-extending assembly of a 3-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **720** engaged with a 6-unit double-receptacle rotator module **151** which in turn is engaged with a closed-tube joiner hub assembly **201**. The corresponding end of a 6-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** is engaged with a side-mounted male member assembly extending from the joiner hub assembly **201**, while the other end of joiner module **460** is engaged with a rotator hub assembly **100** having a tension-adjustment screw knob **58** for adjusting the pivot-tension of the intermittently lockable 360° pan-axis there provided by the rotator hub assembly **100** rotationally engaged upon the male member plate assembly atop the rail-surround rolling module assembly **537**. A bumper component **672** is engaged with the upward-facing wide pivot segment of the pan-axis rotator hub assembly **100** for protection of the camera or other device where it may inadvertently come to meet the hub assembly **100** by rotation of the baseplate assembly **430** upon its 360° tilt-axis provided where the right-side horizontal 3-unit male/receptacle joiner module **720** is rotationally engaged within the corresponding rotator receptacle **11** of the hub assembly **100**.

Example 4: Rolling Jib System

(252) An example of a rolling jib system **780** is illustrated in FIG. **37**, and is configured to provide a compact and lightweight rolling stand system for supporting a load or device such as a still camera or a video camera or a film camera. Such jib assemblies can be configured, for example, to outwardly extend a microphone or a lighting fixture and the like.

(253) In this example, each of a pair of 10-unit wheel-axle/receptacle side-opening joiner modules **800** are side-mounted at one end to opposite sides of a first closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100**. At the other end, a wheel **552** is rotationally engaged with the center bore of each wheel-axle tube-end component **551**. One end of an 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **730** is engaged with the male member assembly extending outward from the first rotator hub assembly **100**. The other end of the joiner module **730** is mounted with the male member assembly of a second closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100**. The outward-extending receptacle of the second rotator hub assembly **100** is engaged with a weight module assembly **600** on a male joiner fitted with a flat end-cap component **695**. A downward-extending grip end-cap module **625** is side-mounted to the second rotator hub assembly **100**. A third rotator hub assembly **100** is side-mounted at a 90° spacing from the grip end-cap module **625**. An upward-extending 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **740** is side-mounted to the third rotator hub assembly **100**.

(254) In this example, a baseplate assembly **400** is engaged with a first double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** extending to the right (in the view shown in FIG. **37**) to which is engaged a fourth rotator hub assembly **100** to which are mounted three grip end-cap modules **625** spaced apart at 90° intervals for handling of the baseplate assembly's tilt and pan operations. One end of a second double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** is mounted to the left side of the baseplate assembly **400** while the other end is engaged with a fifth rotator hub assembly **100** which in turn, is engaged with a downward-extending 10-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **790**. A sixth rotator hub assembly **100** is engaged with the other end of joiner

module **790**. One end of a third double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** is side-mounted to the sixth rotator hub assembly **100**. The other end of the third joiner module **460** is engaged with a double-male extension-tube joiner module **291** that is engaged at its other end with a seventh rotator hub assembly **100** whereby the above baseplate assembly **400** is provided its tilt-axis. Adjacent below, the upward-facing rotator receptacle **11** of an eighth rotator hub assembly **100** provides the above baseplate assembly **400** with a centered 360° pan-axis where it is rotationally engaged with the male member side-mount assembly **110** or **395** extending downward from the seventh rotator hub assembly **100**. A ninth rotator hub assembly **100** is side-mounted to the eighth rotator hub assembly **100** where, on a high-tension setting or intermittently lockable rotation using the pivot lock **60**, the pan-axis rotator hub assembly **100** and modules above can be re-leveled should the jib-arm joiner module **740** engaged with the ninth rotator hub assembly **100** be moved up or down, from where the third rotator hub assembly **100** engaged with the lower end of the jib-arm joiner module **740** is rotationally engaged with the second rotator hub assembly **100**.

(255) A female dome pad end-cap module **641** is side-mounted to the joiner module **730** to cushion the above jib-arm assembly in the event that it is desired to lower it to a position adjacent to the joiner module **730**. The three grip end-cap modules **625** attached to the fourth rotator hub assembly **100** are provided for an operator's hand-control of the tilt and pan rotation of the support assembly. By holding this handgrip assembly, and optionally by also gripping the jib-arm (i.e., the joiner module **740**), the rolling jib assembly **780** can be rolled by the operator by lifting the jib-arm to raise the downward-extending grip end-cap module **625** and then pushing or pulling the rolling jib assembly **780**.

Example 5: Low-Angle Baseplate Support System

(256) An example of a low-angle baseplate support system **810** is shown in FIG. **38**, and is configured to provide a compact low-rolling baseplate system wherein drive and turning movements are performed with a push or pull by an operator gripping two handle attachments which extend upwardly from two sub-assemblies to within the reach of the operator while they are standing or walking. The assembly can be rolled by the operator when lifting a chassis steering bar assembly comprising a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** (with two side-mounted grip end-cap modules **625**), met by a male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **465**, followed by an 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **730**, which is side-mounted amid an 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **830**, which forms the back of a chassis assembly which when lifted removes two back corner grip end-cap modules **625** from the ground allowing the system assembly to advance.

(257) Below two rear corner rotator hub assemblies **100**, the length of extension of the grip end-cap modules **625** is combined with at each a 1-unit double-male extension-tube joiner module **840**, which align approximately the chassis assembly to rest horizontally relative to the radius of the two wheel modules **550**. Extending forward from each of the two rear corner rotator hub assemblies **100** is a 6-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** met by two front rotator hub assemblies **100** where on each is attached outwardly a wheel module assembly **550**. Extending upward from the front two rotator hub assemblies **100** are two 4-unit male/receptacle extension-tube rotator modules **820** with engaged atop two rotator hub assemblies **100** each with their rotator receptacles **11** facing inward thereby providing a baseplate assembly **400** its tilt-axis where engaged between two male/receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **465** which are rotationally engaged within the rotator hub assemblies on each side. Side-mounted from the left-side joiner module **465** is a tilt-axis steering bar assembly comprising the same modules as the lower chassis steering bar assembly, with the direction of the horizontal grip end-cap module **625** reversed, and here configured for the operation of the baseplate assembly's **400** tilt-motion as well as to grip for steering and rolling advancement of the system.

Example 6: Lateral Ground Rail-Tracking Dolly System

(258) An example of a lateral ground rail-tracking dolly system **850** is shown in FIG. **39**, and is

configured to provide a stationary rail track system for rolling a camera or other device therealong during filmmaking or other end-use requirements of a similar nature.

(259) This example comprises three sub-assemblies wherein the first sub-assembly is a stationary rail track system, the second sub-assembly is a pivotable and rotatable camera support structure, and the third sub-assembly is a support framework for the second sub-assembly, comprising two pairs of rail-rolling modules **510**.

(260) The first sub-assembly comprises a pair of rail tracks wherein each rail track is configured with two 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **740** interconnected with a rotator hub assembly **100** and having a rotator hub assembly **100** engaged with the outward-facing ends of the joiner modules **740**. An 18-unit extension-tube joiner module **730** is side-mounted to the rotator hub assemblies **100** at each end of the rail tracks. Each of the six rotator hub assemblies in the first sub-assembly is side-mounted to one end of a downward-extending double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** which is engaged at its other end with a leveling foot module **580**. A joiner module **730** is side-mounted to the two middle downward-extending joiner modules **460** to provide structural support to the rail track sub-assembly.

(261) The second sub-assembly comprises a baseplate assembly **400** to which a camera or other screw-mounted device can be mounted. To the right side of the baseplate assembly **400** is engaged a pan/tilt/jib operating handlebar assembly comprising a 6-unit length double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **151** and a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** capped with a hard end-cap component **690** and with a downwardly extending grip end-cap module **625** to enable an operator's hand control of the baseplate's direction and position. Extending from the left side of the baseplate module **400** is a 4-unit length male/receptacle side-opening joiner module **251** which attaches to a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** to provide an intermittently lockable adjustable-tension 360° device-tilt pivot point controllable with the handlebar assembly to the right of the baseplate. A grip end-cap module **625** is engaged with the hub assembly's **100** left-facing male member for an additional handgrip. Downwardly extending from the rotator hub assembly **100** is a 10-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **710**, which can be locked or provide an off-center 360° device-pan pivot point where met by another rotator hub assembly **100**, to which is mounted a 6-unit length double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** followed by another closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100**, having a bumper component **672** engaged with its upward-facing wide pivot segment, and where met below by a 3-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **720**, provides an intermittently lockable adjustable-tension 360° device-pan pivot point centered below the camera or other pointed device's center, with the ability to adjust the pivot tension using a tension-adjustment screw knob **58**.

(262) Under joiner module **720**, a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** has engaged on both sides two additional of the same (each having mounted a grip end-cap module **625**) where from two 12-unit length double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **475** extend down to each a rotator hub assembly **100** (there inwardly providing a jib-tilt pivot point for the assembly above) engaged centrally to a closed-tube joiner hub assembly **201** from which is side-mounted downwardly a double-receptacle rotator module **151** providing a jib-pan pivot point for the assembly above where it is rotationally engaged with the third sub-assembly. The jib-tilt and jib-pan may be controlled using the grip end-cap module **625** mounted to the end of an 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **730** by a zero-unit length double-male joiner module **281** (not visible). The joiner module **730** also has mounted a counterbalancing weight module assembly **600**.

(263) The third sub-assembly comprises a rolling framework that is configured with a joiner module **730** engaged with a closed-tube joiner hub assembly **201** at each end. Extending laterally from each joiner module **201** is a double-receptacle joiner module **460**. To the outward-facing end of each joiner module **460** is engaged another closed-tube joiner hub assembly **201**. The upward-facing male member plate assembly **420** of a rail-rolling module **510** is engaged with the receptacle of the closed-tube joiner hub assembly **201**. The upward-facing male end of the closed-tube joiner

hub assembly **201** is provided with a grip end-cap module **625**. As mentioned in the paragraph above, one end of a double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **151** is side mounted to the joiner module **730**, and the other end is rotationally engaged with the closed-tube joiner hub assembly **201** that interconnects the lower pair of rotator hub assemblies **100** in the second sub-assembly.

Example 7: Double-Baseplate A-Frame Dolly System

(264) An example of a double-baseplate A-frame dolly system **860** is shown in FIG. **40**, and is configured for use in applications such as filmmaking that may require a combined movement of two cameras or other such devices in tandem. This example comprises two sub-assemblies wherein the first sub-assembly is a rolling A-frame dolly structure, and the second sub-assembly is a rotational support structure for two cameras or other such devices.

(265) The first sub-assembly has an A-framework configured with two A-frames each configured by interconnecting three 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **740** with two 2-way 30° side-mount bracket modules **320** (refer to FIG. **13A**) at the lower two joints and a 30° angle male member mount bracket **322** at the top joint. The two A-frames are interconnected: (i) at the bottom clamped slidably or securely to two 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **740**, and (ii) at the top with an 18-unit extension-tube joiner module **730** to which the mount bracket **322** is mounted with two mount screws **325** each threadably engaged with a square nut provided therefor in the opposing longitudinal channels of the joiner module **730**. The first sub-assembly has four sets of wheel assemblies wherein each set comprises a pair of wheel modules **550** which are mounted to opposite sides of a rotator hub assembly **100**. In this example, each wheel **552** is bolted to the corresponding wheel-axle/receptacle side-opening joiner module **555** at the corresponding axle offset threaded bore **551b** (not visible), so that they act as large casters and rotate naturally into directional alignment with the directional force exerted by the operator to the dolly assembly. Extending from a central third side of the rotator hub assembly **100**, the assemblies include a weight module assembly **600** side-mounted to a joiner module having a flat end-cap component **695**. Rotatable 360° within the upward-facing rotator receptacle **11** of the rotator hub assembly **100**, an upward-extending male/receptacle extension-tube rotator module **640** is rotationally engaged by its male end with the rotator hub assembly **100**, while the other end of the rotator module **640** is securely engaged by a male member side-mount assembly **110** or **395** within the corresponding outward-facing joiner receptacle **211** of its corresponding 36-unit double-receptacle joiner module **740**.

(266) The second sub-assembly has two spaced-apart baseplate modules **400**, each having an individual 360° pan-axis pivot point, and which also may be rotated 360° together at the central pan-axis pivot point. Each baseplate module **400** has a pair of grip end-cap modules **625** mounted to the male member plate assembly **420** on the left side and the right side of the module **400**. One end of a double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **151** is mounted to the downward extending male member plate assembly **420** of the module **400**, and the other end of the rotator module **151** is interconnected with the male end of a closed-tube joiner hub assembly **201**. A downward-extending grip end-cap module **625** is engaged with each joiner receptacle **211** by a zero-unit double-male joiner module **281** (not visible, refer to FIG. **9**). A joiner module **730** engaged with a male member side-mount assembly extending inward from each joiner hub assembly **201** is interconnected with opposite sides of a rotator hub assembly **100** that provides the central 360° pan-axis point. A shell end-cap module **635** is engaged with the top of the rotator hub assembly **100**, while the bottom female end of the rotator hub assembly **100** is rotationally engaged with the male end of a 4-unit male/receptacle joiner module **750**. The female end of the joiner module **750** is side-mounted to the joiner module **730** that interconnects the two A-frames. Providing a central pan-operation handlebar, a joiner module **730** extends from a third side of the rotator hub assembly **100** and is engaged at its outer end with a grip end-cap module **625** mounted by a zero-unit double-male joiner module **281** (not visible).

Example 8: Four-Caster Baseplate Dolly System

(267) An example of a four-caster baseplate dolly system **870** is shown in FIG. **41**, and is configured for use in applications such as filmmaking where it is desirable to have a camera or other such device mounted on a rolling framework as close as possible to the ground or a platform or a table and the like.

(268) This example is configured with two pairs of castor wheel module assemblies **560**, as described in reference to FIGS. **23C** and **23D**. Each pair comprises two 360° pivotable castor assemblies **560** wherein each assembly **560** is engaged with one end of a double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460**, which in turn, is engaged with a closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100** at its other end. The two rotator hub assemblies **100** are interconnected with a joiner module **460**. The male member plate assembly **420** on the right side of the baseplate assembly **400** is engaged with one end of a first double-receptacle rotator module **151**. The other end of the first double-receptacle rotator module **151** is side-mounted to the right-side joiner module **460** that interconnects the corresponding pair of castor assemblies **560**. The male member plate assembly **420** on the left side of the baseplate assembly **400** is engaged with one end of a second double-receptacle rotator module **151**. The other end of the second rotator module **151** is side-mounted to the left-side joiner module **460** that interconnects the other pair of castor assemblies **560**. The two rotator modules **151** in combination provide the tilt-axis point at which the baseplate assembly **400** may be rotated 360°, depending on the length of the mounted device, or may be intermittently locked by one or both of the pivot locks **60** engaged with the pivot-lock sprockets **423** (not visible) of the male member plate assemblies **420**.

Example 9: Hand-Held Camera Stabilizer Assembly

(269) An example of a hand-held stabilizer assembly **880** for camera support is shown in FIG. **42**, and is configured for use in applications where hand-held support is required for a tool or device such as a camera, that may be mounted into a baseplate assembly. In this example, the male member plate assembly **420** on the right side of a baseplate assembly **400** is engaged with one end of a double-receptacle joiner module **460** wherein the other end is engaged with a first closed-tube rotator hub assembly **100**. The female end of a downward-extending 18-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **765** is engaged with the male end of the rotator hub assembly **100**, while the male end of the joiner module **765** is provided with a grip end-cap module **625**. The male member plate assembly **420** on the left side of the baseplate assembly **400** is engaged with one end of a double-receptacle rotator module **151**. The other end of the rotator module **151** is engaged with a second rotator hub assembly **100**. One end of a laterally extending 18-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **765** is engaged with the second rotator hub assembly **100**, while the other end of the joiner module **765** is engaged with a female dome pad end-cap module **641**.

(270) An operator will be able to stably maneuver a camera mounted to the baseplate module **400** by resting the laterally extending joiner module **765** or female dome pad end-cap module **641** on their shoulder, or by holding the joiner module **765** in their left hand so that the female dome pad end-cap module **641** is pressed against their chest, and concurrently holding the downward-extending grip end-cap module **625** in their right hand, whereby they may tilt the camera angle up or down at the tilt-axis point provided by the double-receptacle rotator module **151**.

Example 10: Vertical Rail-Tracking Stand Assembly

(271) An example of a vertical rail-tracking stand assembly **900** is shown in FIG. **43**, and is configured for use in applications where a tool or load such as a camera is required to be moved vertically up and down in a set standing position. This example comprises two sub-assemblies wherein the first is a vertical rail stand, and the second is a pivotable and rotatable rolling support for a camera or other type of device or tool.

(272) The first sub-assembly is a vertical rail comprising an 18-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **765** interconnected with a 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **740** wherein the joiner module **740** is mounted to a male member plate assembly **420** atop a

weighted foot plate **586** of a foot plate module **585**.

(273) The second sub-assembly comprises a pivotable and rotatable camera support structure mounted with a rail-surround rolling module assembly **537**. One end of a double-receptacle rotator module **151** is engaged with a male member plate assembly **420** on the left side of a baseplate assembly **400** (as shown in FIG. **43**) while the other end of the rotator module **151** is engaged with a male member plate assembly **420** extending outward from a rail-surround rolling module assembly **537**, there providing an optional tilt-axis point for the baseplate assembly. A weight component **602** may be provided on the rotator module **151** interposed the baseplate module **400** and the rail-surround rolling module assembly **537**. One end of a double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** is engaged with the male member plate assembly **420** extending outward from the opposite side of the rail-surround rolling module assembly **537**. The other end of the joiner module **460** is engaged with a rotator hub assembly **100**. A male dome pad end-cap module **650** is mounted into the downward-facing receptacle of the rotator hub assembly **100**.

(274) The rail-surround rolling module assembly **537** of the second sub-assembly is slipped over the vertical rail of the first sub-assembly and may be moved upward and downward along the vertical rail as required by an operator. The male dome pad end-cap module **650** is provided to cushion a tool or device that may be mounted into the baseplate module **400** if the second sub-assembly reaches the bottom of the vertical rail of the first sub-assembly.

Example 11: Lighting Support Rack System

(275) An example of a lighting support rack system **910** is shown in FIG. **44**, and is configurable for use in applications such as in filmmaking where industrial lighting or grip equipment is used. These types of configurations may also be useful for supporting other types of loads such as audio equipment, video display equipment, and the like.

(276) In this example, extending vertically from a weighted four-caster base assembly is a three-shaft lighting support rack assembly. The base assembly comprises four matching weighted caster-leg assemblies having each an 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **730** extending from the sides of the lighting support rack assembly's bottom horizontal 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **740** in pairs on two multi-angle male member mount brackets **335** where mounted to the 60° angled bores to form a 120° angle of separation between the two leg extensions. Connected to the outer ends of each of these is another mount bracket **335** connected at their 60° angled bores which aligns the second 60° angled bores to perpendicular to the ground whereon a vertically aligned 6-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** and caster module assembly **560** complete each leg assembly. Where counterbalancing of the upward lighting support rack assembly's load is required, a series of weight components **602** can be secured to the sides of the 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **730**, as shown in FIG. **44**.

(277) Extending upwardly from the lighting support rack assembly's bottom horizontal 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **740** are the three mounting shafts comprising each two 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator modules **920** connected by a zero-unit double-male joiner module **281**. On each of the rotator modules **920** is a repositionable 90° offset side-mount bracket module **340** whereon each is an L-shaped mount arm assembly comprising a closed-tube joiner module hub assembly **201** followed by a 6-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **460** and additional closed-tube joiner module hub assembly **201** whereon are connected the vertically aligned $\frac{5}{8}$ " spigot lighting mount modules **490**, having the spigots **498** on which a range of industrial lighting equipment may be supported. The vertical position of the mounted equipment can be adjusted by repositioning the 90° offset side-mount bracket module **340** on the corresponding square nuts within the square-nut channels along the 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator modules **920**. If equipment size or spacing allows, the mounted equipment may also be pivoted 360° on the horizontal plane by rotating the 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator modules **920** where three of them are connected to the top of the horizontal

36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **740**, and three connected to the top of the first three. For the structural integrity of these types of lighting support rack assemblies, an additional horizontal 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **740** is connected to the ends of the upper three 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator modules **920**, completing the rectangular frame of the lighting mount assembly.

Example 12: A-Frame Spooling Cart System

(278) An example of an A-frame spooling cart system **930** is shown in FIG. **45**, and is configured for use in applications where a mobile cart can be used for collecting, and moving around a location, various loads such as cable, wire, rope, hose, fabric, and the like.

(279) In this example, across the width of the cart at the top of the A-frame is a spool bar assembly which can be rotated 360° by the operator on its 6-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator modules **151**, by holding the assembly **930** at its grip end-cap modules **625** which extend outward from each side from a joiner-box sub-assembly. Each of the joiner-box sub-assemblies comprises three 6-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **460**, a 6-unit male/receptacle side-opening joiner module **940**, and three closed-tube joiner hub assemblies **201** at three corners. The fourth corner of the joiner-box sub-assemblies are mounted to the spool assembly's cross bar by two male member side-mount assemblies **110**.

(280) The A-frame rolling chassis comprises two A-frames configured by interconnecting three 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **740** with two 2-way 30° side-mount bracket modules **320** (refer to FIG. **13A**) at the lower two joints and a 30° angle male member mount bracket **322** at the top joint. The two A-frames are interconnected: (i) at the bottom clamped to two 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **740**, and (ii) at the top with the two rotator modules **151** situated at the end of the spool bar assembly. At the four corners of the A-frame rolling chassis, mounted to the ends of two of the four base 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner modules **740**, there are engaged four closed-tube joiner hub assemblies **201**. Extending downward from each joiner hub assembly **201** is a 6-unit male/receptacle extension-tube rotator module **640**, providing the directional pivot point of the cart system's wheel modules **550** that are side-mounted on two sides of a rotator hub assembly **100** at the base of each extension-tube rotator module **640**. In this example, the wheels **552** are bolted to the wheel module's **550** wheel-axle/receptacle side-opening joiner module **555** at corresponding axle offset threaded bores **551b** (not visible), so that these wheel module assemblies will act as large casters and rotate naturally into directional alignment with the directional force exerted by the operator to the dolly assembly. Extending from a central third side of the rotator hub assembly, the wheel module assemblies include a weight module assembly **600** side-mounted to a joiner module having a flat end-cap component **695**.

Example 13: Pull Cart Assembly

(281) An example of a pull cart assembly **950** suitable for a golf-bag is shown in FIG. **46**. Such assemblies can be configured for transporting other types of tall vertical loads such as pressurized gas canisters. In this example, the pull cart assembly **950** comprises a vertical shaft sub-assembly with a first baseplate module **400**, a horizontal wheel sub-assembly with a second baseplate module **400**, and leg support sub-assembly.

(282) The vertical shaft sub-assembly comprises an 18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **730** interconnected with a 10-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **790** with a zero-unit double-male joiner module **281** linking the two receptacles. The open end of the joiner module **790** is engaged with one side of a first rotator hub assembly **100** while the other side of the first rotator hub assembly **100** is engaged with a 3-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **720**. A second rotator hub assembly **100** is engaged with the other end of the joiner module **720**. A bumper end-cap module **670** is mounted to the wide pivot segments of both of the rotator hub assemblies **100**, and three grip end-cap modules **625** are side-mounted to the second rotator hub assembly **100** at 90° intervals.

(283) The horizontal wheel sub-assembly comprises a third rotator hub assembly **100** to which a pair of 10-unit wheel-axle/receptacle side-opening joiner modules **800** are engaged at opposite sides of the hub assembly **100**. A wheel **552** is bolted to the center bore of each wheel-axle module **800**.

(284) The leg support sub-assembly comprises a downward-extending 3-unit double-male extension-tube joiner module **955** to the bottom of which is engaged a grip end-cap module **625**. A fourth rotator hub assembly **100** is engaged with the top of the joiner module **955**. A laterally extending 10-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **710** is side-mounted to the fourth rotator hub assembly **100**. A fifth rotator hub assembly **100** is side-mounted to the open end of the rotator module **710**, while a 4-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module **750** is side-mounted to the other side of the fifth rotator hub assembly **100**. A second baseplate assembly **400** is mounted to the fifth rotator hub assembly **100**. The open end of the joiner module **750** is mounted to the third rotator hub assembly **100** of the horizontal wheel sub-assembly.

(285) A first baseplate module **400** mounted to the first rotator hub assembly **100** can be adjusted to firmly grip therein and then re-adjusted to release the side of a golf bag, for example. A second baseplate module **400** mounted to the fifth rotator hub assembly **100** can be adjusted to firmly grip therein and then re-adjusted to release the bottom of the golf bag.

Example 14: Utility Cart and Shelf Assemblies

(286) FIG. **47** is a perspective view of an exemplary utility cart assembly **960** comprising some of the exemplary modules disclosed herein. The system assembly as shown provides both an open tray and box tray carriage function for transporting equipment, properties, materials, supplies, and the like around a worksite or other location. Optionally, in place of wheel modules, similar assemblies may be configured with foot modules **580**, **585**, or grip end-cap modules **625** at its base for standing shelf and storage assemblies.

(287) In this example, the utility cart system **960** comprises four pairs of 360° pivotable caster-style wheel module assemblies **550** which are of a similar configuration as those described in Example 2, Example 7, and Example 12, using the off-center bores of their wheel-axle/receptacle side-opening joiner modules **555**. Attached upwardly from each of these wheel assembly's corresponding rotator modules **640**, there engaged by a zero-unit double-male joiner module **281**, is a 36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module **740** providing the basis of the cart's frame. Secured from these corner post joiner modules **740** via tray collars **474** are the cart's three tray module assemblies having each the tray bottom **471** and three or four side panels **478** for containment of the load (see description in reference to FIG. **18**). The grip end-cap modules **625** are provided atop two of the joiner modules **740**, there each engaged by a zero-unit double-male joiner module **281**, for pushing or pulling the utility cart in any direction on the 360° pivotable wheel module assemblies **550**.

Example 15: Modular Workstation Assembly

(288) An example of a modular workstation assembly **980** is shown in FIG. **48**.

(289) This example comprises a rectangular table top **990**, a shelf **482** situated above the table top **990**, and a rotatable under-shelf **995** mounted underneath the table top **990** adjacent the right side of the assembly.

(290) The bottom surface of the table top **990** is provided with four circular recesses close to each of the corners of the table top **990** (refer to FIG. **19B**). Each recess is configured to receive and house therein a mounting plate **484**. The mounting plate **484** with a central threaded bore **485** is inserted into the recess and securely mounted to the table top **990** with, for example, five screws **487** inserted through bores **486** provided therefor in the mounting plate **484**. A male member flat-mount assembly **361** is mounted to the mounting plate **484** with a mounting bolt threadably engaged with the threaded bore **485**. Then, the male member flat-mount assembly **361** is inserted into the receptacle in the end of a 24-unit double-receptacle side-opening joiner module **488** and secured in place as described for joiner module **251** in reference to FIG. **8B**. All four modules **488** are mounted in this manner to the four corners of the table top **990**. At the base of the four joiner

modules **488**, there may be provided foot components such as shown four soft end-cap components **680**.

(291) In this example, a fifth recess is provided on the bottom surface of the table top **990** to receive and engage therein a fifth mounting plate **484** mounted to a male member flat-mount assembly **361**. The top surface of the under-shelf **995** shown in this example is provided with a recess near the rear edge of the shelf **995** for receiving and mounting therein a sixth mounting plate **484** mounted to a male member flat-mount assembly **361**. One end of a 6-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module **151** is engaged with the downward-extending male member flat-mount assembly **361** from the fifth mounting plate **484**, while the other end is engaged with the upward-extending male member flat-mount assembly **361** from the sixth mounting plate **484**. It is to be noted that the right edge of the under-shelf **995** has been contoured to matingly engage the side of the corresponding module **488** when rotated out from under the table top **990** toward the front right. One or more additional shelves **995** may be similarly engaged to the bottom of the table top **990**.

(292) This example also shows a shelf **482** provided at the rear of the table top **990** adjacent to the left edge. Two appropriately spaced-apart recesses **483** are provided along the rear edge of the table top **990** into which are inserted and mounted with screws **487**, mounting plates **484** mounted to male member flat-mount assemblies **361** (as illustrated in FIG. 19B). A pair of complimentary recesses are provided in the bottom surface of the shelf **482** into which, are inserted a pair of mounting plates **484** mounted to male member flat-mount assemblies **361**. One end of a 6-unit double-receptacle side-opening joiner module **489** is engaged with the downward-extending male member flat-mount assembly **361** from a mounting plate **484** mounted in a recess in the bottom surface of the shelf **482**, while the other end is engaged with the upward-extending male member flat-mount assembly **361** from the mounting plate **484** mounted into the top surface of the table top **990**.

(293) It is to be noted that the table tops may be square, rectangular, trapezoidal, triangular, pentagonal, hexagonal, heptagonal, octagonal, decagonal, circular, kidney-bean shaped, wave-shaped, and may have other forms of symmetrical and asymmetrical curvilinear shapes. Although it will be most common that the modular table assemblies disclosed herein are provided with four legs, it is optional to provide three legs for triangular table tops, and alternatively, to provide two legs at the front edge of a table top that may have been configured to fold down against a wall when not in use, and to fold out when use is desired. In such two-leg configurations, the legs may fold up against the bottom surface of the table top when the table top is folded down, and to fold down when the table top is unfolded for use. Additionally, it is optional to provide table configurations with one or two legs on broad foot assemblies such as an A-frame configuration or the foot plate module **585**, described in reference to FIG. 24C.

(294) TABLE-US-00001 NUMBERING KEY 10-closed-tube rotator module (FIGS. 1, 2) 11-rotator receptacle 15-closed-tube housing 18 -tube-end screw slot 20-rotator receptacle assembly (FIG. 5) 21-lock-spring rotator half-socket 22-lock-release rotator half-socket 23-screw 24-outer bushing channel 26-outer bushing 28-inner bushing channel 30-inner bushing 32-pivot-lock channel 34-square-nut slot 36-square nut 38-side-mount bore 40-retaining-lock set screw 42-retaining-lock screw bore 44-release button hole 50-retaining lock 52-retaining half-lock with spring receptacles 54-retaining half-lock with release button 55-retaining lock-release button 56-biasing spring 58-tension-adjustment screw knob 60-pivot lock 62-pivot-lock indexing peg 64-pivot-lock button 65-lock-hold tab 70-male component 71-male member closed-tube end assembly 74-pivot-lock sprocket 78-wide pivot segment 79-octagonal boss assembly (FIG. 6B, 7) 81-octagonal recess 82-prongs 84-narrow pivot segment 86-retaining-lock chamfer 87a-first collar (with leading chamfer 86) 87b-second collar 88-neck 89-threaded bore 90-connector screw 100-closed-tube rotator hub assembly (FIG. 3A) 101-6-way closed-tube rotator hub assembly (FIG. 3B) 110-male member side-mount assembly (FIG. 3A, B) 112-pivot-lock sprocket 116-wide pivot

component 118-octagonal boss 120-bolt 151-double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module (FIG. 4) 152-4-way double-receptacle extension-tube rotator hub assembly (FIG. 5) 155-extension-tube housing 160-side-mount bore 162-retaining-lock screw bore 164-release button hole 168-tube-end screw slot 170-longitudinal square-nut channel 180-middle square-nut holder 182-tube rail channels 184-positioning-rod threaded bore 186-positioning set screw 201-closed-tube joiner hub assembly (FIG. 6A) 210-5-way closed-tube joiner hub 211-joiner receptacle 215-joiner closed-tube housing 216-pivot-lock sprocket 218-tube-end screw slots 220-joiner receptacle assembly 221-lock-spring joiner half-socket 222-lock-release joiner half-socket 223-prong-retaining slot (FIG. 6, 7) 224-outer bushing channel 228-inner bushing channel 234-square-nut slot 238-side-mount bore 244-release button hole 251-male/receptacle side-opening joiner module (FIG. 8) 252-side-opening receptacle 255-extension-tube housing 256-longitudinal square-nut channel 257-tube-end screw slots 258-side-mount bore 260-side-opening receptacle component 262-prong-retaining slot 265-side connector screw 268-side-opening receptacle cover 270-male member extension-tube end assembly 271-male member tube-end plate 272-pivot-lock sprocket (FIG. 8B, 10) 274-wide pivot segment 275-octagonal boss 278-screw hole 281-double-male joiner module (FIG. 9) 282-double-male component 284-pivot-lock sprocket (FIG. 9) 286-wide pivot segment module (FIG. 13D) 288-octagonal boss 291-double-male extension-tube joiner module (FIG. 10) 295-extension-tube housing 296-square-nut channel 297-tube-end screw slot 298-side-mount bore 301-6-way extension-tube joiner hub assembly (FIG. 11) 311-double-male adapter joiner module (FIG. 12) 312-adapter joiner component 314-alternative male member component 316-threaded screw slot 320-2-way 30° side-mount bracket module (FIG. 13A) 322-30° angle male member mount bracket 323-mount screw hole 325-mount screw 326- 60° angle between the 110s 328-clamp bracket 329-clamp bracket screw 330-4-way multi-angle side-mount bracket module (FIG. 13B) 331-mount screw hole 332-mount screw 334-30°/45°/60° angled bores 335-multi-angle male member mount bracket 336-bracket screw bore 338-bracket screw 339-washer 340-2-way 90° offset side-mount bracket module (FIG. 13C) 341-90° angle offset male member mount bracket 342-mount screw hole 346-screw-access opening 350-1-way 45° offset side-mount bracket 351-cylindrical 45° offset male member mount bracket 352-mount screw hole 353-central bore 354-peg hole 355-elbow male member mounting block module 356-cube male member mounting block module 357-triangular male member mounting block module 358-pyramidal male member mounting block module 359-hexagonal male member mounting block module 360-octagonal male member mounting block module 361-male member flat-mount assembly 362-pivot-lock sprocket (FIG. 13) 363-central bore 365-peg 366-wide pivot component slot 367-wide pivot component 368-connector teeth 369-octagonal boss 370-2-way elbow male member mounting block 371-central bore 372-peg holes 373-6-way cube male member mounting block 374-central bore 375-peg hole 376-5-way triangular mounting block 377-4-way pyramidal mounting block 378-8-way hexagonal mounting block 379-10-way octagonal mounting block 380-5° increment adjustable male member mount module (FIG. 15) 381-male-mount half housing 382-side-mount bore 383-adjustment screw through-hole 384-peg hole 385-adjustment screw 386-rotation-adjustment half housing 387-threaded bore 388-5° increment teeth 389-bracket screw bore 390a-bracket 1 390b-bracket 2 391-bracket screw 392-bracket screw bore 393-central bore 394-peg hole 395-alternative male member side-mount assembly 396-pivot-lock sprocket 397-central bore 399-wide pivot component slot 400-baseplate assembly (FIG. 16) 402-baseplate body assembly 402a-baseplate top plate 402b-baseplate bottom plate 404-mounting screw 405-baseplate bore 406-baseplate screw 408-mounting bracket slot 410-mounting bracket 412-bracket arm 413-threaded bore 415-bracket side plate 416-side plate threaded bore 417-support plate 418-support pad 419-side plate screw 420-male member plate assembly 422-mounting plate 423-pivot-lock sprocket 424-wide pivot segment 425-octagonal boss 426-screw hole 428-screws 430-baseplate assembly (FIG. 17) 435-tool mount plate 436-mounting screw 437-tool-mounting slot 440-plate screw holes module 441-access bores 442-screws 445-plate wedges 446-plate screw bores 447-bracket screw holes 450-male mount slider component 452-

mounting holes 453-mount screws 454-central bore 455-peg holes 456-bracket screw bores 460-double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module (FIG. 17) 465-male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module (FIG. 17) 466-longitudinal channel 470-tray module assembly (FIG. 18) 471-tray bottom 472-orifice 473-collar bores 474-collar 475-double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module 476-collar screw 477-longitudinal square-nut channel 478-side panel 479-side panel screw 480-desk assembly (FIG. 19) 481-desk top 482-shelf 483-plate recess 484-mounting plate 485-threaded bore 486-screw bores (x5 per side) 487-plate screws (x5 per side) 488-double-receptacle side-opening joiner module 489-double-receptacle side-opening joiner 490-lighting mount module (FIG. 20A, B) 492-extension-tube housing 494-spigot mount plate 495-tube-end screw bores 496-threaded bore 497-screw 498-demountable 5/8" spigot 500-lighting mount module (FIG. 20C, D) 501-spigot-adaptor male member component 502-spigot 503-spigot receptacle 504-set screw 505-screw bore 506-pivot-lock sprocket 507-wide pivot segment 510-rail-rolling module (FIG. 21A, 22) 512-carriage plate 514-spring-suspension roller assembly 516-axle block 518-roller 520-axle bolt 522-spring block 524-suspension bolt 526-spring tension set-screw 528-spring tension plate 530-spring 532-spacer plate 535-fixed roller assembly 536-axle block 537-rail-surround rolling module assembly (FIG. 21B, 22) 538-side plate 540-friction-pad plate 542-friction pad 544-tension adjustment knob 546-pad plate spring 548-retaining ring 550-wheel module assembly (FIG. 23A, B) 551-wheel-axle tube-end component 551a-central threaded bore 551b-offset threaded bores 552-wheel 554-axle bolt 555-wheel-axle/receptacle side-opening joiner module 560-caster wheel module assembly (FIG. 23C, D) 562-mount component 564-threaded bore 566-peg hole 568-caster wheel 580-leveling foot module (FIG. 24A, B) 581-adjustable foot component 582-threaded leveling rod 583-foot end 584-nut 585-foot plate module (FIG. 24C) 586-foot plate 587-threaded bores 590-pivotable support module (FIG. 25) 592-pivot bracket 593-lock nut 594-pad component 595-threaded bores 596-suction-cup component 598-knob 599-washer 600-weight module assembly (FIG. 26) 602-weight component 603a-outer bores 603b-center bore 604-bolt 605-double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module (similar to FIG. 4) 606-extension-tube housing 608-longitudinal square-nut channel 610-telescoping extension module (FIG. 27) 612-extension-tube housing 614-rod-retaining component 616-rod-retaining plate 618-adjustment collar component 619-screws 620-threaded rod 621-second threaded portion 622-spacer plate 624-lock nut 625-grip end-cap module (FIG. 28) 626-handle grip component 627-semi-circular end-cap portion 628-hand grip portion 629-inner sleeve 630-prong-retaining slot 631-outer sleeve 632-retainer tab 635-shell end-cap module (FIG. 29) 636-half-shell cap 637-screw 638-bore 640-male/receptacle extension-tube rotator module (FIG. 29) 641-female dome pad end-cap module (FIG. 30A, B) 642-female dome pad 643-collapsible framework 645-central orifice 646-female dome mounting plate 647-bores 648-screw 649-mounting plate orifice 650-male dome pad end-cap module (FIG. 30C, D) 652-male dome pad 653-dome collapsible framework 654-male dome mounting plate 656-bore 657-peg holes 658-bores 660-seat module (FIG. 31) 662-seat pad 670-bumper end-cap module (FIG. 32) 672-bumper component 674-screw 680-soft end-cap component (FIG. 33A, B, C) 681-elongate leg component 682-mount plate 683-bores 685-screws 686-inserts 688-soft dome component 689-threaded bore 690-hard end-cap component 691-leg component 692-retaining-lock chamfer 693-flat surface 695-flat end-cap component 696-bore 697-extension-tube housing 698-threaded screw slot 700-crab-steering dolly system 710-10-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module 720-3-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module 730-18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module 740-36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module 750-4-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module 754-12-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module 756-4-unit double-male extension-tube joiner module 760-vertical rail-tracking dolly system 765-18-unit male/receptacle extension-tube joiner module 770-lateral mounted rail-tracking dolly system 780-rolling jib system 790-10-unit double-receptacle extension-tube joiner module 800-10-unit wheel-axle/receptacle side-opening joiner module 810-low-angle baseplate support system 820-4-unit male/receptacle extension-tube rotator

module 830-18-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module 840-1-unit double-male extension-tube joiner module 850-lateral ground rail-tracking dolly system 860-double-baseplate A-frame dolly system 870-four-caster baseplate dolly system 880-hand-held camera stabilizer assembly 900-vertical rail-tracking stand assembly 910-lighting support rack system 920-36-unit double-receptacle extension-tube rotator module 930-A-frame spooling cart system 940-6-unit male/receptacle side-opening 950-pull cart assembly 955-3-unit double-male extension-tube 960-utility cart assembly joiner module 980-modular workstation assembly 990-table top 995-under-shelf joiner module

Claims

1. A kit of portable modular components for use in demountably configuring a structural assembly, the kit comprising: two or more of a male end component having a distal end comprising a cylindrical body having at least one linear set of prongs around a circumferential surface of the cylindrical body wherein each set of prongs has two or more spaced apart prongs, and a proximal end comprising one of a flat base or a concave base; and one or more of a first elongate structural support component having a pair of opposed female ends; and/or one or more of a second elongate structural support component having the male end component at one end and the female end at the opposite end; and/or one or more of a third elongate structural support component having the female end at one end and an end cap at the opposite end; wherein each of said female ends has a cylindrical receptacle configured for demountably receiving and engaging therein the cylindrical body; and each of said female ends is provided with one or more locking assemblies for releasable engagement therein with the male end component at the end of one of the second elongate structural support component; or the male end component extending radially from one of the first, second, or third elongate structural support components; or the male end component at an end of or extending radially from one of a fourth elongate structural support component having a pair of opposed male ends, or the male end component at the end of or extending radially from one of a fifth elongate structural support component having the male end component at one end and an end cap at the opposite end; or the male end component extending radially from one of a sixth elongate structural support component having a pair of opposed end caps.
2. A kit according to claim 1, wherein the receptacle has one or more linear channels for slidably receiving therein the at least one linear set of prongs.
3. A kit according to claim 1, wherein the receptacle has one or more prong-retaining slots for slidably receiving therein the at least one linear set of prongs.
4. A kit according to claim 1, wherein one or more of said female ends are provided with a first locking assembly for releasable engagement therein with one of the male end component.
5. A kit according to claim 4, wherein the first locking assembly is configured for reversibly engaging a first lock sprocket provided at a base of the male end component extending outward from another one of the portable modular components.
6. A kit according to claim 5, wherein the locking assembly comprises an extendible and retractable indexing peg.
7. A kit according to claim 5, wherein the first lock sprocket provided at the base of a first male end component has a flat surface for demountable engagement of the first male end component with a flat surface of one of the portable modular components.
8. A kit according to claim 5, wherein a second lock sprocket provided at the base of a second male end component has a concave surface for demountable engagement of the second male end component with a round surface of one of the portable modular components.
9. A kit according to claim 1, wherein at least one of said female ends is provided with a second locking assembly comprising a retaining lock having a retaining half-lock with one or more spring receptacles in cooperation with a retaining half-lock with a release button.

10. A kit according to claim 1, wherein an exterior side wall of the receptacle is provided with a demountably engageable hatch extending longitudinally therealong, whereby demounting the hatch opens the cylindrical receptacle for a sideways insertion of the cylindrical body into the receptacle and reengaging the hatch and threadably engaging a screw or a bolt with the hatch securely engages the cylindrical body with the receptacle.
11. A kit according to claim 1, wherein one of the male end components is rotatable around a longitudinal axis of one of the female ends of one of the first, the second, or the third elongate structural support component.
12. A kit according to claim 1, additionally comprising one or more modules configured for demountable engagement of an imaging device or a sound recording device or a sound reproduction device or a lighting device or a light-directing device or a wheel assembly or a mounting plate for a power tool wherein each of said modules comprises: (i) a male end component for a rotational or a fixed demountable engagement with a female end at the end of the first, the second, or the third elongate structural support component, or (ii) a female end component for a rotational or a fixed demountable engagement with a male end component at the end of or extending radially from the first, the second, the third, the fourth, the fifth, or the sixth elongate structural support component.
13. A kit according to claim 1, additionally comprising one or more of a wheel module or a counter-weight balance module or a dome pad module or a seat module wherein each of said wheel module, said counter-weight balance module, said dome pad module, and said seat module comprises: (i) a male end component for a rotational or a fixed demountable engagement with a female end at the end of the first, the second, or the third elongate structural support component, or (ii) a female end component for a rotational or a fixed demountable engagement with a male end component at the end of or extending radially from the first, the second, the third, the fourth, the fifth, or the sixth elongate structural support component.
14. A kit according to claim 1, additionally comprising one or more of a capping module wherein said capping module comprises: (i) a male end component for demountable engagement with a female end at the end of the first, the second, or the third elongate structural support component, or (ii) a female end component for demountable engagement with a male end component at the end of or extending radially from the first, the second, the third, the fourth, the fifth, or the sixth elongate structural support component.
15. A kit according to claim 14, wherein the capping module is one or more of a handgrip module, a handle module, a fixed-foot module, an adjustable-foot module, a capped end plug module, a cap plate module, a bumper module, and a suction-cup module.
16. A kit according to claim 1, wherein an elongate structural element is interposed on the pair of opposed ends of the first, the second, the third, the fourth, the fifth, or the sixth elongate structural support component, wherein the elongate structural element is a tube or a rod, said tube or said rod having a circular cross-section or an elliptical cross-section or a square cross-section or a rectangular cross-section or a trapezoidal cross-section or a triangular cross-section or a hexagonal cross-section or an octagonal cross-section or a decagonal cross-section or an I-shaped cross-section.
17. A kit according to claim 16, wherein one or more of the elongate structural element has one or more demountable male end components extending radially outward therefrom, each of said male end components comprising a cylindrical body with at least one linear set of prongs on the circumferential surface of the cylindrical body, wherein each set of prongs has two or more spaced apart prongs, and wherein each of the male end components is configured for a rotational or a fixed demountable engagement with the female ends.
18. A kit according to claim 1, additionally comprising one or more flat sheet-stock modules to which one or more male end components are fastenable, or through which one or more orifice(s) provided in the flat sheet-stock therefor, one or more of the first, the second, or the third elongate

structural support component are demountably engageable.

19. A kit according to claim 1, additionally comprising one or more of a tray assembly comprising: a tray bottom component wherein each corner is at least partially internally radiused; a plurality of the portable modular components, wherein both ends are provided with a female cylindrical receptacle or both ends are provided with a male end or one end is provided with a female cylindrical receptacle and the other end is provided with a male end, and wherein each of the plurality of modular components has a diameter that slidably engages one of the at least partially internally radiused corners of the tray bottom component; wherein each of the plurality of portable modular components is slidably engaged with one or more collar component(s), said collar component(s) configured for demountable engagement with the portable modular component thereby providing a stable support for the tray bottom component.

20. A kit according to claim 19, additionally comprising one or more tray side components wherein each tray side component is demountably engaged with one or more collar components demountably engaged with opposing portable modular components positioned at the corners of the tray bottom component.

21. A kit according to claim 1, additionally comprising one or more two-piece collar clamp(s) wherein an outward-facing surface of the one or more pieces of the two-piece collar clamp(s) is/are configured for demountable engagement with one male end component or two male end components or three male end components or four male end components.

22. A kit according to claim 21, wherein the one or more two-piece collar clamps are configured for demountable engagement with the first, the second, the third, the fourth, or the fifth elongate structural support component.

23. A kit according to claim 1, additionally comprising one or more three-piece collar clamps wherein (i) one of the pieces of the collar clamp is configured for encircling one half of a shaft, said piece having an outward-facing surface configured for demountable engagement with one male end component or two male end components or three male end components or four male end components, and (ii) wherein the other two pieces are matching and are configured for encircling one quarter of the shaft.

24. A kit according to claim 21, wherein one or more of the collar clamps are additionally configured for demountable engagement with a flat plate.

25. A kit according to claim 24, wherein the flat plate is configured for demountable engagement of an imaging device or a sound recording device and/or a sound reproduction device or a lighting device or a light-directing device or a power tool.

26. A kit according to claim 23, wherein one or more of the collar clamps are additionally configured for demountable engagement with a flat plate.

27. A kit according to claim 26, wherein the flat plate is configured for demountable engagement of an imaging device or a sound recording device or a sound reproduction device or a lighting device or a light-directing device or a power tool.

28. A kit according to claim 1, additionally comprising one or more mounting blocks for demountable engagement with one or more outward-facing male end components.

29. A kit according to claim 28, wherein the mounting block is one of a cube or an equilateral pyramid having a base and three upward-extending surfaces or an equilateral pyramid having a base and four upward-extending surfaces.

30. A kit according to claim 28, wherein the mounting block is one of a round shape, a triangular block, a square block, a rectangular block, a pentagonal block, a hexagonal block, a heptagonal block, an octagonal block, and a decagonal block.

31. A kit according to claim 1, additionally comprising one or more first rail-rolling modules wherein each rail-rolling module comprises: a carriage plate having an outward-facing surface and an opposed inward rail-facing surface; a male end component engaged with the outward-facing surface of the carriage plate, said male end component comprising a cylindrical body with at least

one linear set of spaced-apart prongs on the circumferential surface of the cylindrical body; and a pair of roller assemblies engaged with the carriage plate at approximate opposite ends of the carriage plate, wherein each of the roller assemblies comprises an axle block having matching inclined axle ends extending toward or from the inward rail-facing surface of the carriage plate and a free-spinning roller demountably engaged with each inclined axle end.

32. A kit according to claim 31, wherein each of the inclined axle ends extends toward or from the inward rail-facing surface of the carriage plate by an angle selected from a range of 5 degrees to 80 degrees.

33. A kit according to claim 31, wherein a spacer plate is demountably engaged with the outward-facing surface of the carriage plate whereon the male end component is demountably engaged with the spacer plate.

34. A kit according to claim 31, wherein each of the roller assemblies is fitted with a shock-absorbing element.

35. A kit according to claim 31, wherein the inward rail-facing surface of the carriage plate is fitted with a deployable and retractable friction plate for controllable engagement and disengagement with a rail.

36. A kit according to claim 31, additionally comprising a second rail-rolling module wherein the second rail-rolling module comprises two first rail-rolling modules interconnected by at least one side plate wherein the side plate is affixed at a first end to the inward rail-facing surface or a side edge of the carriage plate interposed the pair of roller assemblies of one of said first rail-rolling modules, and wherein the side plate is affixed at a second opposite end to the inward rail-facing surface or a side edge of the carriage plate interposed the pair of roller assemblies of the other of said first rail-rolling modules.

37. A kit according to claim 36, wherein an outward-facing surface of the at least one side plate is engaged with: (i) an outward-extending male end component, or (ii) a spacer plate whereon the male end component is engaged with the spacer plate.

38. A kit of parts for configuring a rail-rolling module assembly, comprising: a carriage plate having an outward-facing surface and an opposed inward rail-facing surface, wherein the outward-facing surface is a demountable spacer plate; a male end engaged with the outward-facing surface of the carriage plate, said male end comprising a cylindrical body with at least one linear set of spaced-apart prongs on a circumferential surface of the cylindrical body; and a pair of roller assemblies engaged with the carriage plate at approximate opposite ends of the carriage plate, wherein each of the roller assemblies comprises an axle block having matching inclined axle ends extending toward or from the inward rail-facing surface of the carriage plate and a roller demountably engaged with each said inclined axle end.

39. A kit according to claim 38, wherein each of the inclined axle ends extends toward or from the inward rail-facing surface of the carriage plate by an angle selected from a range of 5 degrees to 80 degrees.

40. A kit according to claim 38, wherein the male end is demountably engaged with the demountable spacer plate.

41. A kit according to claim 38, wherein each of the roller assemblies is fitted with a shock-absorbing element.

42. A kit according to claim 38, wherein the inward rail-facing surface of the carriage plate is fitted with a deployable and retractable friction plate for controllable engagement and disengagement with a rail.

43. A kit according to claim 38, additionally comprising a second rail-rolling module wherein the second rail-rolling module comprises two first rail-rolling modules interconnected by at least one side plate wherein the side plate is affixed at a first end to the inward rail-facing surface or a side edge of the carriage plate interposed the pair of roller assemblies of one of said first rail-rolling modules, and wherein the at least one side plate is affixed at a second opposite end to the inward

rail-facing surface or a side edge of the carriage plate interposed the pair of roller assemblies of the other of said first rail-rolling modules.

44. A kit according to claim 43, wherein an outward-facing surface of the at least one side plate is engaged with: (i) an outward-extending male end, or (ii) a spacer plate whereon the male end is engaged with the spacer plate.

45. A kit of parts for configuring a rail-rolling device, the device comprising: a top carriage plate having an outward-facing surface, an opposed inward rail-facing surface, a pair of roller assemblies engaged with said top carriage plate at approximate opposite ends of said top carriage plate, wherein each assembly of the pair of roller assemblies comprises an axle block having matching inclined axle ends extending toward or from the inward rail-facing surface of said top carriage plate, and wherein each of said inclined axle ends has a free-spinning roller demountably engaged with each end; a bottom carriage plate having an outward-facing surface, an opposed inward rail-facing surface; and a pair of roller assemblies engaged with said bottom carriage plate at approximate opposite ends of said bottom carriage plate, wherein each assembly of the pair of roller assemblies comprises an axle block having matching inclined axle ends extending toward or from the inward rail-facing surface of said bottom carriage plate and wherein each of said inclined axle ends has a free-spinning roller demountably engaged with each end; and at least one first side plate affixed at a first end to the inward rail-facing surface or a side edge of said top carriage plate interposed on the pair of roller assemblies, and wherein the at least one said first side plate is affixed at a second opposite end to the inward rail-facing surface or a side edge of said bottom carriage plate interposed on the pair of roller assemblies.

46. A kit according to claim 45, wherein each of the inclined axle ends extends toward or from the inward rail-facing surface of the top carriage plate and the bottom carriage plate by an angle selected from a range of 5 degrees to 80 degrees.

47. A kit according to claim 45, wherein an outward-facing surface of the top carriage plate and/or the bottom carriage plate is engaged with: (i) an outward-extending male end, or (ii) a spacer plate whereon is engaged the outward-extending male end.

48. A kit according to claim 45, wherein each of the roller assemblies is fitted with a shock-absorbing element.

49. A kit according to claim 45, wherein the inward rail-facing surface of the top carriage plate and/or the bottom carriage plate is fitted with a deployable and retractable friction plate for controllable engagement and disengagement with a rail.

50. A kit according to claim 45, wherein an outward-facing surface of the at least one first side plate is engaged with: (i) an outward-extending male end, or (ii) a spacer plate whereon is engaged the outward-extending male end.

51. A kit according to claim 45, wherein a second side plate is interposed on the top carriage plate and the bottom carriage plate opposite the at least one first side plate.

52. A kit according to claim 51, wherein an outward-facing surface of the second side plate is engaged with: (i) an outward-extending male end, or (ii) a spacer plate whereon is engaged the outward-extending male end.
